

DELHI HITS 70-LAKH
SAPLING TARGET **P3**



AMIT SHAH SAYS UP ON COURSE TO
BECOME USD 1 TRILLION ECONOMY **P5**

'I WAS JUST
REMOVED' **P14**



Plea in SC seeks prosecution of CEC, challenges his unilateral decisions

Three BJP allies urge CEC to clear air on SIR row, dissent by ECs

VINAY KUMAR
New Delhi, September 25

As the controversy and political upheaval rages over the administration and decision-making process at the Election Commission, a petition has been filed before the Supreme Court against Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar.

The Public Interest Litigation (PIL) has been filed based on media reports regarding important decisions of the commission.

The petition alleges that several decisions related to the electoral process were taken without the concurrence of the other two Election Commissioners, saying such actions violate the statutory requirement of collective decision-making.

The PIL, filed by advocate Shaileendra Mani Tripathi, also seeks a declaration that decisions, guidelines and software modifications



» CEC GYANESH KUMAR PUTS OFF UP, HIMACHAL, UTTARAKHAND VISITS; RESCHEDULING ROUTINE, SAY OFFICIALS

KEY POINTS

- » Petitioner cites statutory collective decision-making requirements.
- » PIL invokes Section 18 of 2023 EC Act
- » Majority view prevails during commissioners' disagreement, Section 18 says
- » Plea seeks declaring alleged decisions unconstitutional and void
- » Chirag Paswan urges EC to dispel public concerns
- » Upendra Kushwaha also calls for addressing electoral concerns
- » TDP's Lavu seeks transparency to strengthen institutional confidence

ECI adds 'VIP' tagging tool to voter verification app

AGENCIES
New Delhi, September 25

The Election Commission of India quietly rolled out a new "Mark VIP" function within the BLO app used by booth-level officers during the ongoing special intensive revision of electoral rolls across 16 states and three union territories, Hindustan Times has learned. The update went live on July 30, with Apple's App Store logging the change a day later under the description "mark VIP elector-related changes". No corresponding update appeared on the Play Store, and the commission did not respond to queries about the feature's purpose or authorization. **CONTINUED ON P4**

Cong hits streets seeking CEC Kumar's resignation

Asks him to turn 'approver' or face trial



AAISHA SABIR
New Delhi, September 25

Congress workers staged protests across several states on Friday demanding the resignation and removal of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar over the poll body's handling of the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls.

The protests were organised as part of a nationwide programme directed by the All India Congress Committee (AICC), with party workers marching towards Election Commission offices and raising slogans against Kumar in Assam, Jammu and Kashmir, Uttarakhand, West Bengal, Uttar Pradesh, Chandigarh, Manipur, Arunachal Pradesh and other states. The protesters also demanded an independent review of all decisions and electoral roll changes made under CEC Kumar.

The opposition party also accused the Election Commission of carrying out an "unprecedented attack" on voter equality by allegedly creating a specific 'Mark VIP' feature in the BLO application and urged Kumar to either turn "approver" or face trial.

Several senior leaders, including party's deputy leader in Lok Sabha Gaurav Gogoi, and workers were detained. **CONTINUED ON P4**

A terrorist country is asking me: Jaishankar rebuffs Pakistani journalist at UN

MPOST BUREAU
United Nations, September 25

External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar on Friday hit back at a Pakistani journalist who accused India of sponsoring terrorism in Pakistan, saying the question came from a "terrorist country".

Jaishankar was speaking alongside Liberia's Foreign Minister Sara Beysolow Nyanti at the UN headquarters on the Group of Friends on Safety and Security of Shipping and Seafarers when the journalist raised the question.

"When will your government stop sponsoring terrorism in Pakistan?" the journalist asked Jaishankar.

"A terrorist country is asking me that question. Come on," Jaishankar responded.

India's Permanent Representative to the UN, Harish Parvathaneni, then told the journalist: "You have heard your reply. You have heard your response, loud and clear."

The exchange came a day after **CONTINUED ON P4**

Briefs

Brij Bhushan's acquittal challenged by four wrestlers

NEW DELHI: Four women wrestlers have approached a sessions court challenging the acquittal of former Wrestling Federation of India (WFI) chief Brij Bhushan Sharan Singh in a sexual harassment case. **CONTINUED ON P4**

Mandeep K Bhandari appointed CBSE chairperson

NEW DELHI: Senior bureaucrat Mandeep K Bhandari was appointed chairperson of the Central Board of Secondary Education (CBSE) following a bureaucratic reshuffle effected by the Centre on Friday.

Bhandari, a 2001 batch Indian Administrative Service (IAS) officer of the AGMUT (Arunachal Pradesh, Goa, Mizoram, and Union Territories) **CONTINUED ON P4**

Centre extends AFSPA for 6 months

NEW DELHI: The Centre has extended the Armed Forces (Special Powers) Act, 1958, in specified areas of Nagaland, Arunachal Pradesh and Manipur for another six months from October 1, according to Gazette notifications issued on Friday.

The orders followed a "further review of the law and order situation" in the three states and will remain in force unless withdrawn earlier. **CONTINUED ON P4**

NCPI MPs get two weeks to reply to LS disqualification notices

AGNIHOTRI GUPTA
Kolkata, September 25

The 20 Nationalist Citizens Party of India (NCPI) MPs, who had sought four weeks to respond to notices issued in connection with disqualification proceedings, have been given two weeks by Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla.

The MPs, including Sudip Bandyopadhyay and Kakoli Ghosh Dastidar, have been asked to submit their replies by October 8.

The Speaker had sought their response on why they left the Trinamool Congress and joined the NCPI and why the anti-defection law should not be applied against them.

The MPs were initially given seven days to respond, followed by three weeks and then another two weeks. After the latest deadline of September 22 passed, **CONTINUED ON P4**

Modi urges BJP workers to focus on social reform

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 25

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Friday called on BJP workers to work for social reform and positive change instead of focusing on vote banks, saying political workers should contribute to addressing social problems.

Interacting virtually with participants of the ongoing 'Seva Yatra' motorcycle rally from Varanasi to Vadnagar, Modi



cited Mahatma Gandhi as an example of a leader who combined the freedom struggle with efforts against social evils. He said those engaged in serving society should have their work respected. **CONTINUED ON P4**

111 MPs and MLAs changed parties after winning polls since 2022: ADR

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 25

As many as 111 MPs and MLAs changed political parties after winning elections to Parliament or state assemblies between 2022 and 2026, with Nagaland and West Ben-

gal recording the highest number of such cases, according to an analysis by the Association for Democratic Reforms (ADR) and National Election Watch.

The analysis covered elections and bypolls during the **CONTINUED ON P4**

Suruchi, Kamaljeet strike shooting gold

Baranica Elangovan wins historic bronze in women's pole vault

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 25

As many as 111 MPs and MLAs changed political parties after winning elections to Parliament or state assemblies between 2022 and 2026, with Nagaland and West Bengal recording the highest number of such cases, according to an analysis by the Association for Democratic Reforms (ADR) and National Election Watch.

The analysis covered elections and bypolls during the period and found that 26 Lok Sabha members, seven Rajya Sabha members and 78 MLAs switched parties. The cases included individual defections, party mergers,



HIGHLIGHTS

- » Suruchi Singh and Kamaljeet clinch shooting gold
- » Pair sets Games and Asian record
- » Aishwary, Rudranksh and

Niraj win shooting silver

- » Gulveer Singh wins 10,000m silver
- » Manpreet Kaur wins shot-put bronze
- » Manush Shah and Diya Chitale win TT bronze

resignations followed by victories in bypolls and dis-

qualification followed by winning a **CONTINUED ON P4**



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‘I was crying in pain’: 17-yr-old recounts Astha Kunj gangrape

‘Took away their mobile phones, led the girl to an isolated stretch’

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, September 25

“I was crying in pain” -- a 17-year-old girl told police as she recounted the ordeal she went through inside southeast Delhi’s Astha Kunj Park, where three men allegedly separated the girl from her friend, snatched their phones and took her to an isolated part of the park before raping her at knife-point.

The survivor’s first statement to the police forms a crucial part of the ongoing investigation into the alleged gangrape that took place on September 21 evening.

According to her statement, the girl and her 17-year-old male friend went to the park after offering prayers at Kalkaji Mandir and were sitting on a bench eating chips when the three men approached them.

“Why have you come here at this time? It is not allowed to come here,” the men allegedly asked the two, before separating them and taking them towards different sides of the park.

When the frightened girl asked not to separate her and told them to talk to her mother if they wanted, one of the accused said, “Asif bhai gun nikal (Take out the gun, Asif)”.

The accused allegedly took away their mobile phones and led the girl towards an isolated stretch, where she said the men threatened her with knives.

According to her statement, Asif allegedly removed her clothes,



Central district police boost women’s safety

New Delhi, September 25

The Delhi Police’s Central district team has intensified women-centric public outreach and preventive policing under Operation Shishtachaar to enhance safety in public spaces, markets, parks and residential areas.

ACP Karol Bagh recently interacted with more than 100 UPSC aspirants, senior citizens and residents at Sindhi Park, Rajinder Nagar, where female aspirants raised safety concerns. Police teams have also been visiting paying guest accommodations and residential facilities to interact with

women residents and address their grievances.

A meeting with Residents’ Welfare Associations and Market Welfare Associations was held at Ajmal Khan Park, with over 50 participants discussing local safety measures and community participation.

The police are strengthening the ‘Eyes and Ears’ network, urging residents to report suspicious activity, harassment and situations requiring assistance. Preventive patrolling and area domination have also been intensified at vulnerable, isolated and high-footfall locations. MPOST

placed her on a red bench and asked another accused, identified as Hemu, to stand guard.

“He kept a knife on my neck while raping me. I was crying; I was feeling a lot of pain,” she said, while recounting the ordeal she had to go through with Asif raping her while holding a knife to her neck.

She further alleged

that Hemu then took her to another bench and sexually assaulted her while threatening her with a knife. The third accused, identified by the survivor as Deepu, allegedly sexually assaulted her there-after, also while holding a knife to her neck, according to the statement.

The survivor also claimed that Asif used a

condom during the assault while the other two discharged on the side.

After the alleged assault, they gave her the clothes except the undergarments and told her to quickly put on her clothes. They threatened to kill her and her friend if they told anyone about the incident.

The accused allegedly returned their mobile phones and took the girl and her friend out of the park. The girl then told her friend what had happened, following which he called the police control room.

A PCR call was received at around 8.45 pm, according to police records, following which a police team reached the survivor and her friend near Gate No. 7 of Astha Kunj Park.

The survivor subsequently guided the forensic science team to the spot where she alleged that the assault took place.

The FSL and district mobile crime team examined the area and collected biological and other evidence, including condoms found near the alleged crime spot, for forensic examination and DNA testing, officials said.

The case has since seen multiple arrests, with one of the accused, Asif, being injured in an exchange of fire with police.

The incident has also raised concerns over security arrangements at the sprawling 142-acre park, including poorly lit stretches, broken portions of the boundary wall and multiple access points that visitors and vendors say remain difficult to monitor after dark.

MCD sanitation worker found dead

New Delhi, September 25

A 40-year-old MCD sanitation worker was found dead with a cord tied around his neck at a vacant government plot in north Delhi’s Mukhmelpur on Friday, police said.

The deceased was identified as Ravi Kumar, a resident of Mukhmelpur, they said.

According to the post-mortem examination report, the probable cause of death appears to be hanging, police said.

Viscera has been preserved for further examination. The doctors also noticed an alcohol-like smell in the stomach contents.

Police received information regarding a body lying at a vacant government plot in Valmiki Mohalla and reached the spot, where Kumar was found with the cord around his neck. A similar cord was also found at the spot, police said.

Police are probing Kumar’s death from all angles after his brother found him dead amid a matrimonial dispute. MPOST

Blaze at multi-storey building in Delhi’s Model Town, 30 rescued

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, September 25

Around 30 people were rescued after a fire broke out in a three-storey building housing a Haldiram outlet and adjoining structures in northwest Delhi’s Model Town area on Friday, officials said.

The fire broke out around 2 pm, following which Head Constable Pawan, the beat officer of Model Town police station, became the first responder and alerted senior officers, police said.

Thick smoke was seen billowing from the building which has a basement, ground floor and three upper floors.

The Delhi Fire Service received a call about the blaze at around 2.40 pm and initially rushed four fire tenders to the spot.

As the fire intensified, the DFS deployed 23 units, including a hydraulic platform, officials said.

The police team evacuated occupants of the



‘FIRE STARTED FROM THE GROUND FLOOR AND ENGULFED THE WHOLE BUILDING...’

affected building as well as those in adjoining buildings, safely rescuing a total of 30 people, police said.

“The building has a basement, ground and three floors. On the ground and first floor there is Haldiram and on second and third floor there is one more restaurant. The fire was in all the floors. We have searched the entire

building and no one was trapped inside,” a DFS officer said.

The blaze, suspected to have been caused by a short circuit, broke out in a multi-storey building housing the Haldiram outlet and other establishments.

“The fire was classified as a medium fire at 3.30 pm and was brought under control around 4 pm,” he said.

Speaking to reporters, Md Sajid, assistant Bank manager of a private bank, said, “As soon as the short circuit happened, the guard informed us that fire has broken out and we should evacuate the building. The fire started from the ground floor and engulfed the whole building. We used fire extinguisher in our office to try to extinguish fire as much as we could on an individual level.”

No injury or casualty was reported due to the timely police response and prompt evacuation, they said.

Two held for ‘harassing’ Hindu College students

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, September 25

Two DU students were arrested on Friday in connection with the alleged harassment of two Hindu College students in northwest Delhi’s Mukherjee Nagar, while a sports utility vehicle (SUV) used by them was also seized, an official said. Accused Abhinav and Abhimanyu are students of the Delhi University (DU), he added.

According to the complainant, she and her friend were walking in the Mukherjee Nagar area on Wednesday evening when a white car approached

AN OFFICIAL STATED THAT A SPORTS UTILITY VEHICLE (SUV) USED BY THEM WAS SEIZED. ACCUSED ABHINAV AND ABHIMANYU ARE STUDENTS OF THE DELHI UNIVERSITY (DU)

them and the men inside allegedly passed comments at them. When the women objected, the men allegedly abused them and started following them.

The complainant has alleged that when she and her friend stopped to film the incident, the car also stopped and the men attempted to pull them into the vehicle. The accused fled when the complainant’s friend started filming

the car.

Based on the complaint, an FIR was registered at the Mukherjee Nagar police station under sections 78 (stalking), 79 (word, gesture or act intended to insult the modesty of a woman) and 3(5) (common intention) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS).

Deputy Commissioner of Police (Northwest) Akansha Yadav said police launched an investigation

based on the complaint and traced the vehicle used in the incident.

Police identified the accused driver as Naman, a DU student, and said two to three persons were accompanying him at the time of the incident.

“Abhinav has been arrested from Laxmi Nagar and Abhimanyu from Gurugram, while efforts are underway to nab the others,” a senior police officer said.

Police are also looking into the student’s allegation that she and her friend had approached multiple police stations before the complaint was registered.

SATYA NIKETAN INCIDENT

‘High-powered panel to examine student accommodation, safety’

New Delhi, September 25

The Delhi High Court was informed on Friday that the Delhi government has constituted a High-Powered Committee to examine student accommodation and safety issues and recommend time-bound measures, following the September 6 Satya Niketan building collapse.

A bench of Chief Justice Devendra Kumar Upadhyaya and Justice Tejas Karia was told that five MCD officers, including a deputy

THE COMMITTEE WAS CONSTITUTED ON SEPTEMBER 10

commissioner, had been suspended following the incident. The MCD also said a magisterial inquiry was constituted to examine building permissions, compliance with bye-laws and the role of officials.

A survey of 2,453 PG buildings across 12 MCD zones found 2,342 visi-

bly safe, while 91 required minor repairs, 30 major repairs and four were categorised as dangerous. Eight load-bearing structures and 77 framed structures have been identified for close monitoring. The committee, constituted on September 10, decided to prepare a regulatory framework for PG accommodations and private student hostels, with the DTTE and Higher Education Department to jointly draft the framework. PTI

LSR enhances security, lighting & police presence after Astha Kunj park incident

New Delhi, September 25

Lady Shri Ram College for Women (LSR) on Friday reviewed security around the campus, with enhanced patrolling and other safety measures being implemented in the area following the alleged rape of a minor at the nearby Aastha Kunj Park.

The LSR Students’ Union said it is receiving regular updates on increased patrolling around the college, including in the National Park and Vikram Vihar. This includes patrol-

ling by the Delhi Police’s Pink Squad.

On Thursday, the college said a WhatsApp group comprising the LSR administration, students’ union and senior police personnel was created to facilitate timely action and enable students to report incidents and concerns.

The presence of police personnel has been ensured at the Pink Booth near the college and at its back gate, while work is underway to improve street lighting on the road behind the college,

the students’ union said.

Security is being fortified at specific locations around the college that the students identified as unsafe or requiring attention, it said.

These were “important steps”, the students’ union said, stressing that the process would continue, with efforts focused on checking whether the measures were visible and effective on the ground.

It urged students to continue sharing their experiences and feedback

EDUCATIONWORLD RANKINGS

Four Delhi govt schools secure top spots in national rankings

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, September 25

Delhi’s government schools have featured prominently in the EducationWorld India School Rankings 2026-27, with four DBRA CM Shri Schools securing places among the top seven state government day schools nationally.

DBRA CM Shri School, Sector 10, Dwarka, ranked third, followed by the Yamuna Vihar and Sector 19, Dwarka schools at fifth and sixth. The Surajmal Vihar campus ranked seventh.

The rankings, released by EducationWorld in association with AZ Research Partners, were based on



ARMY PUBLIC SCHOOL, DELHI CANTT, TOPPED CENTRAL GOVT DAY SCHOOLS CATEGORY...

a nationwide survey of 18,000 parents, teachers, educators and counsellors across 34 cities. The 20th edition assessed

4,500 schools across 22 states and 34 cities on 14 parameters, including academic reputation, faculty competence, leadership, curriculum, infrastructure, sports and student well-being.

Army Public School, Delhi Cantt, topped the Central Government Day Schools category, while Springdales School, Dhaula Kuan, ranked first among co-educational day schools.

The Shri Ram School and Nirmal Bhartia School shared second place in the latter category. Several other Delhi schools also featured in girls’, boys’, legacy and international categories. MPOST

Residents protest DDA’s proposed layout changes

New Delhi, September 25

Residents of the Saraswati and Narmada multi-storied flats have protested against the DDA’s proposed restructuring of the residential complex, alleging that the plan would reduce designated green spaces and expand commercial development.

The residents said the original 2001 layout provided for one Local Shopping Complex (LSC), along with five nursery schools and a library. They alleged the DDA now plans two LSCs and commercial or residential plots in areas marked as recreational and green zones.

They said the original plan earmarked 73,224 square metres of green and soft-green area, but the existing green cover is already less than the planned area.

Residents also raised concerns over the proposed highway and tunnel opening near Nelson Mandela Road, which they said would require the society’s boundary wall to be shifted by about 7.5 metres.

On Friday, DDA personnel arrived with a JCB to begin construction, prompting a protest.

The residents have sought intervention from the DDA Vice-Chairman and demanded that the original layout be protected and any land-use changes follow due process. MPOST

LAUDS NDMC STAFF

Safer, smarter and...: L-G's 4-pillar roadmap for world-class Delhi

SHIVANGI SHUKLA
New Delhi, September 25

Delhi Lieutenant Governor Sardar Taranjit Singh Sandhu on Thursday outlined a four pillar roadmap for a world-class Delhi during his participation in various NDMC events, stressing safer streets for women and children, AI enabled civic services, zero waste neighbourhoods and Jan Bhagidari as a shared civic responsibility.

Interacting with NDMC employees at the NDMC Convention Centre, Sandhu congratulated the civic body for securing first position in the 'Swachhta Hi Sewa' campaign and appreciated sanitation workers, gardeners, engineers and other staff for keeping New Delhi clean, green and well-maintained.

He said frontline workers were the "true brand ambassadors" of the city and stressed their safety, dignity, welfare and institutional support.

Sandhu said well lit roads, elimination of dark spots, effective grievance tracking, better service delivery, scientific waste disposal and zero waste colonies could improve citizens' quality of life. He also said cleanliness could not be the responsibility of the government alone



CLOSER LOOK

- » 'Frontline workers were the 'true brand ambassadors' of the city & stressed their safety, dignity, welfare and institutional support'
- » He also appreciated NDMC's civic services during major international engagements, including the BRICS Summit, and highlighted 100 per cent source segregation under the Swachhta Hi Sewa campaign as an important step towards sustainable waste management

and citizens must actively participate. The L-G interacted with employees on medical requirements, women's safety at work-places and surrounding areas, mechanisation of sweeping, concerns about possible unemployment due to technology, recreational facilities, canteens and the need for new accommodation.

He later visited Anupam Colony in Chanakyapuri, where he appreciated the RWA's efforts towards 100 per cent source segregation and on site composting. He said such community led initiatives should inspire

similar efforts across Delhi. Sandhu also inaugurated a Dental Health Awareness and Preventive Oral Health Camp at Dharam Marg, where he visited stalls on oral health, geriatric care, tobacco and cancer awareness, child oral health and 3D dental care.

He also appreciated NDMC's civic services during major international engagements, including the BRICS Summit, and highlighted 100 per cent source segregation under the Swachhta Hi Sewa campaign as an important step towards sustainable waste management.

Sahasrabuddhe sets focus on MCD polls

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 25

Newly appointed in-charge of Delhi BJP Vinay Sahasrabuddhe on Friday took charge at the state unit office and asserted that the party will contest the MCD polls next year with "full confidence".

Sahasrabuddhe, a former Rajya Sabha MP, is credited with BJP's impressive victory in municipal corporation elections in 2017. "There are high expectations from the BJP because we have a government both in Delhi and at the Centre, and all seven MPs in the city represent our party. The results of the BJP government's work are visible on the ground. We will contest the MCD polls with full confidence," he told reporters.

The last MCD elections in 2022 resulted in a loss for the BJP, which was defeated by the Aam Aadmi Party (AAP). The next MCD elections, covering 250 wards, will take place next year.

"It is a matter of great pride for me to assume the responsibility of Delhi BJP

IT IS A MATTER OF GREAT PRIDE FOR ME TO ASSUME THE RESPONSIBILITY OF DELHI BJP IN-CHARGE

in-charge on the birth anniversary of Pandit Deendayal Upadhyaya," the Delhi BJP cited Sahasrabuddhe as saying in a statement. He paid floral tributes to Pandit Deendayal Upadhyaya at the Delhi BJP office and later held a brief meeting with state president Harsh Malhotra, state general secretaries Pawan Rana, Vishnu Mittal, Yogita Singh and Mohan Lal Gihara.

During the meeting, talks were held on providing a new direction and renewed energy to the state organisation.

"I am already familiar with most of the workers of Delhi BJP and deeply appreciate their organisational skills. Together, we will work towards achieving a major victory in the 2027 MCD polls," he said in the statement.

Delhi SIR: Notices to prominent voters cleared after verification

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 25

The details of most of the prominent voters who received notices as part of the ongoing Special Intensive Revision (SIR) exercise in Delhi have been validated through field verification and their names reserved for inclusion in the final electoral roll, poll officials said.

BJP stalwart L K Advani, former vice president Jagdeep Dhankhar, External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar, Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, former chief minister Arvind Kejriwal, and several other prominent figures from across various fields, were issued notices over 'discrepancies' in their enumeration forms.

Most of them were issued notices for being "unmapped with last SIR" in Delhi in 2002. Most such prominent persons were voters in the New Delhi Assembly constituency.

In the past few days, teams of poll officials, including booth-level officers (BLOs), visited such voters to validate their details through the support-

ing documents stipulated by the Election Commission (EC), the officials said on Thursday. After verification, names of such voters were reserved for inclusion in the final electoral rolls of Delhi to be published on November 4, they said.

According to the EC's instructions, names of members of the judiciary, public representatives, holders of declared offices and personalities from fields of arts, culture, journalism, sports, and public services among others – flagged in the electoral database – were issued notices after their names did not figure in the draft roll published on August 31.

It was done so that necessary documents could be collected from them during the claims and objection phase, the officials said.

More than 97 lakh electors figure in the draft electoral roll, while some 33.13 lakh electors have been identified for notices over discrepancies in their enumeration forms.

A large number of the cases relate to voters whose details could not be matched with the electoral

roll prepared during the previous SIR in 2002.

The office of the Delhi chief electoral officer has maintained that issuance of a notice does not mean that a voter's name will be deleted from the electoral roll. No name can be deleted without giving the elector an opportunity of being heard and passing a proper speaking and appealable order, it said.

Special camps at colleges for first-time voters

The Delhi poll body will hold special enrolment camps at colleges, universities and other educational institutions on September 29 and 30 to facilitate registration of first-time voters as part of the ongoing SIR of electoral rolls, officials said on Friday. According to a statement issued by the office of the Delhi Chief Electoral Officer, the camps are aimed at maximising enrolment of young electors in the 18 to 25 age group. Booth-level officers will be present at the camps with electoral rolls and blank Form-6, which is used for inclusion of names in the electoral roll.

Shah to inaugurate 4 major road projects on Sept 29

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 25

Union Home Minister Amit Shah is likely to inaugurate four major road infrastructure projects on September 29, including the Barapullah Phase-3 elevated corridor, Delhi Cabinet minister Parvesh Sahib Singh said

on Friday. According to the Delhi Public Works Department Minister Singh, Shah will also lay down the foundation stone for two new flyovers – Modi Mill to Kalkaji and Savitri Cinema half flyover – on September 29.

"The Mukarba Chowk underpass, which has been

completed, will also be inaugurated on the same day by the home minister. The projects altogether will be a major step towards resolving the traffic congestion problems in the city," Singh said.

The Barapullah-Phase 3 corridor, which is the biggest of the four projects,

aims to provide seamless connectivity between East and South Delhi, linking Mayur Vihar Phase-1 and AIIMS via signal-free carriageways.

The new flyover will merge with the existing Barapullah flyover at Sarai Kale Khan, completing a stretch of around 9 km.

Originally approved in 2014 and initiated in 2015, the project was initially scheduled for completion in 2017. However, it faced multiple delays and significant cost overruns, with the revised project cost now at approximately Rs 1,635 crore.

Briefs

Pollution control at Punjabi Bagh

NEW DELHI: The Delhi government has directed various agencies to intensify efforts against pollution sources, including dust, vehicular emissions, construction activities, and waste, particularly in the Punjabi Bagh hotspot, to improve coordination ahead of the winter months, officials said on Friday.

100 children, 1 clean message

NEW DELHI: Over 100 children from two state-supported residential schools in Meerut experienced the Namo Bharat and Meerut Metro services during an educational trip organised by the NCRTC under the 'Swachhata Hi Seva' campaign, with a focus on cleanliness and responsible use of public spaces.

Traffic study likely for Sarai Kale Khan

NEW DELHI: With an aim to reduce traffic congestion towards South Delhi, the Delhi government is planning to come up with a decongestion plan for the Sarai Kale Khan stretch on Ring Road, officials said on Friday. A high-level coordination committee meeting on traffic congestion was held earlier, where the issue of heavy traffic congestion at Sarai Kale Khan was raised by Delhi Traffic Police.

Delhi hits 70-lakh sapling target

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 25

The Delhi government has achieved its target of planting 70 lakh saplings under its 'Mission Green Delhi' campaign, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said on Friday.

The campaign, launched during Van Mahotsav on July 7, saw participation from government departments, local bodies, schools, colleges, resident welfare associations (RWAs), NGOs and citizens, according to the Chief Minister's Office.

Gupta said the achievement was not merely about meeting a numerical target but aimed at expanding Delhi's green cover and strengthening its ecosystem.



A total of 24,94,505 saplings were planted in the Central Ridge, DDA Ridge and South Ridge areas as part of the campaign, the government said. The campaign also saw significant public participation, with 1,89,116 bookings made through a public slot booking facility. Of these, 1,47,095 citizens participated and planted 3,56,986 saplings, it said.

Under the 'Vriksh Rath'

initiative, 74,747 saplings were distributed to colonies and communities, of which 21,394 were planted, while 7,61,827 saplings were distributed to citizens, institutions, organisations and communities through government nurseries.

Gupta said the next phase of the campaign would focus on ensuring the survival and growth of the saplings and she appealed to citizens to regularly nurture and protect the plants. Environment Minister Manjinder Singh Sirsa said the participation of citizens, RWAs, students, NGOs and various institutions had given the campaign the character of a people's movement.

PUBLIC NOTICE

STOP MOSQUITOES before they start breeding

Water in container for birds must be changed weekly.

Scrub, dry and change water of Cooler weekly.

Keep the lid of water tank closed. Don't let water tank overflow.

Don't let water collect near construction sites.

Don't let water collect around home. Put petrol in accumulated water.

Don't keep cups, tyres, containers, etc. around your home in the open during rains.

Join the movement against Dengue, Malaria & Chikungunya

Non-compliance of the said advice will lead to the legal action as per the provisions under relevant sections of the New Delhi Municipal Council (Malaria and other Mosquito-borne diseases) bye-laws 2007.

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**MP: 5 boys
feared drowned,
1 dead during
Ganesh idol
immersions**

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Bhind, September 25

Five boys were feared to have drowned and another died in separate incidents during Ganesh idol immersions in Madhya Pradesh on Friday, police said.

While three boys went missing in Bhind, two brothers were untraced in Khandwa and a boy drowned in Sehore, police said.

In Bhind, three boys aged 16-17 went missing around 4.30 pm after entering the Sindh river near Kanawar village to immerse an idol, Superintendent of Police Suraj Verma told reporters.

The missing boys were identified as Krishna Bhadauria, Abhijit Bhadauria and Madan Bhadauria.

"A search operation was launched amid rain, but strong currents in the river have made the search difficult," SP Verma said.

LANDMARK MARITIME INITIATIVE

India, Liberia launch sea personnel safety group amid attacks on seafarers, shipping



EAM S Jaishankar, Foreign Secretary Vikram Misri and Minister of Foreign Affairs of Liberia Sara Beysolow Nyanti, in New York

Liberia's Minister for Foreign Affairs Sara Beysolow Nyanti, launched the 'Group of Friends on Safety & Security of Ship-

ping & Seafarers' here on the margins of the high-level UN General Assembly session.

India and Liberia will

serve as co-chairs of the Group of Friends, which would focus on various aspects of maritime trade, safety, and secu-

rity. As an inclusive platform, Jaishankar said the endeavour has been to bring all relevant stakeholders together.

UNGA MARGINS
EAM Jaishankar meets Iranian, Russian counterparts

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
United Nations, September 25

External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar on Friday met his counterparts from Iran and Russia, with discussions ranging from bilateral issues, cooperation in the BRICS grouping and the Gulf conflict.

Jaishankar met Russian Foreign Minister Sergey Lavrov and discussed bilateral issues as well as cooperation in the BRICS grouping.

"A good meeting with FM Sergey Lavrov of Russia today #UNGA81. Exchanged views on a number of ongoing issues. Also took stock of our bilateral and BRICS cooperation," Jaishankar said, referring to the grouping of Brazil, China, Egypt, Ethiopia, India, Indonesia, Iran, Russia, Saudi Arabia, South Africa and United Arab Emirates.

India earlier this month hosted the BRICS Leaders' Summit that was attended

INDIA EARLIER THIS MONTH HOSTED THE BRICS LEADERS' SUMMIT THAT WAS ATTENDED BY RUSSIAN PRESIDENT VLADIMIR PUTIN AND IRANIAN PRESIDENT MASOUD PEZESHKIAN

by Russian President Vladimir Putin and Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian.

Jaishankar also met Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi on the margins of the high-level UNGA session here.

"Appreciate the conversation with FM @araghchi of Iran at the @UN #UNGA81. We discussed the latest developments with regard to the Gulf conflict. Will continue to be in touch," he said.

From page 1

CEC

leader Lavu Srikrishna Deva-rayalu said transparency would help strengthen confidence in the constitutional institution.

"Let me make it clear that as part of the government, I do not intend to defend what is a constitutional body. I am also not much worried about the allegations made by the opposition, which will always take a stand that suits it politically," Paswan who heads Lok Janshakti Party, told reporters.

"If people start losing trust in the electoral system, that will not augur well for democracy and, therefore, I think the Election Commission must come out with its clarification more forcefully. It must dispel misgivings in the minds of the people," he said.

The main opposition party Congress staged protests by attempting to march towards state election commission offices in various parts of the country, demanding CEC Kumar's immediate arrest, removal from office, and an independent review of all decisions and electoral roll changes made under him.

Grabbing the issue relating to the functioning of the EC, the Congress also accused the Election Commission of carrying out an "unprecedented attack" on voter equality by allegedly creating a specific 'Mark VIP' feature in the BLO application and urged Kumar to either turn "approver" or face trial.

The PIL further seeks to have all those decisions declared illegal and demands the reinstatement of the original 'Form 6'. The petition also demands an investigation by a Special Investigation Team (SIT) into how the names of 13 crore voters were removed from the electoral rolls during the ongoing Special Intensive Revision (SIR).

The petition also seeks the prosecution of CEC Kumar, Senior Deputy Election Commissioner Maneesh Garg, and Director General (IT) Seema Khanna for alleged dereliction of duty under the Representation of the People (RP) Act.

The PIL was filed days after The Indian Express reported that Election Commissioners Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi had recorded objections on at least 14 occasions over decisions and orders concerning SIR, including changes to Form 6 and the management of electoral-roll data. The report said the objections related to decisions allegedly taken without their knowledge or against their recommendations.

The petition also alleged that the Election Commission's digital systems were increasingly centralised, restricting the stat-

tutory powers of Electoral Registration Officers and other officials at the field level.

The plea further raises concerns over the handling of electoral roll revisions in Goa and West Bengal. It alleged that the software did not have a facility to restore 97 eligible electors in Goa despite directions for their verification.

In West Bengal, the petitioner claimed that more than 16.10 lakh appeals were filed in the name of the EC against voters whose names had been restored by judicial officers. It alleged that the other two Election Commissioners and the West Bengal chief electoral officer were not aware of or had not authorised these appeals.

The petitioner has argued that the CEC is the "first among equals" in the multi-member EC and does not have a superior voting power or veto over the other commissioners.

The plea seeks preservation of server logs, databases, communications and metadata relating to the EC's electoral-roll management systems from October 1, 2025, onwards.

Meanwhile, Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar has postponed his visits to Uttar Pradesh to attend conferences of electoral literacy clubs, with officials saying rescheduling of dates is a routine exercise.

The officials noted that similar conferences in Ladakh, Himachal Pradesh and Uttarakhand were also postponed in the recent past.

Cong hits streets

as police used barricades to stop them from marching towards the state election commission offices in various state capitals.

The protests come in the wake of The Indian Express report that questions were repeatedly raised on issues related to the SIR of electoral rolls within the three-member Election Commission (EC) by two of the three commissioners Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi.

The national rollout of SIR has been under the supervision of all three commissioners. But Sandhu and Joshi have formally objected, on record, at least 14 times over the last 10 months to decisions taken and orders issued, they say, without their knowledge, according to the Express investigation.

In Delhi, Congress leaders and workers staged a protest against Kumar, demanding his resignation and an independent audit of SIR of electoral rolls in the city.

Several party workers gathered at the Delhi Congress office on Rouse Avenue and marched towards the BJP headquarters

on Deen Dayal Upadhyaya Marg before proceeding to the Election Commission office at Nirvachan Sadan.

Also, wearing masks bearing Kumar's face and with their hands bound in chains, Indian Youth Congress workers in Delhi protested against the EC, demanding Kumar's resignation.

Addressing a press conference here, Congress' media and publicity department head Pawan Khera said all decisions taken by Kumar including SIR are "null and void".

"We are sure the Supreme Court is watching what is happening and will take the right steps at the right time," he said.

"We want to say to Gyanesh Kumar: it's done bro. Heed Rahul Gandhi's advice -- resign and turn approver," Khera said, adding that if Kumar does not do so, he should be ready to face trial.Congress general secretary in-charge organisation KC Venugopal said, "Gyanesh will go, it's a matter of time. And then Congress will make it happen."

The protests held by our leaders and workers across the country demanding his removal are just the beginning, he said.

"There will be a massive outpouring of the defenders of democracy, against the 'desh-drohis' who are out to destroy it," Venugopal said.

Every Indian who is even slightly concerned about saving our democracy should step out and mount unbelievable pressure on this regime and its puppets to fix accountability for this daylight robbery of our vote, and to ensure those guilty are severely punished for destroying our democracy, he said.

Jaishankar

an Indian journalist asked Pakistan Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif a similar question as he entered the UN building.

"When will you stop harbouring terrorists?" the journalist asked Sharif on Thursday.an Indian journalist asked Pakistan Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif a similar question as he entered the UN building.

"When will you stop harbouring terrorists?" the journalist asked Sharif on Thursday.

Modi urges

Modi also spoke about changes in rural India over the past 12 years, saying the gap between cities and villages had narrowed significantly, village infrastructure had improved and women had become more self-reliant.

He praised sanitation workers involved in the Prayagraj Kumbh Mela, saying their efforts helped make the event known worldwide for cleanliness. Modi recalled washing their feet to seek their blessings and acknowledge their contribution to India's honour.

He said the Seva Yatra had personal significance, with his journeys across districts and villages shaping his understanding of public service.

Vadnagar, his birthplace, gave him values that shaped his life, while Varanasi added new dimensions of service, he said.

Two motorcycle rallies were flagged off on September 17, Modi's 76th birthday, from Vadnagar and Varanasi. The journeys will conclude on October 7 and mark 25 years of his public service.

The rallies are passing through villages, towns and districts, where participants are meeting residents and undertaking local service activities. They are also interacting with beneficiaries, women and youth to understand the impact of welfare and empowerment programmes.

Modi also recalled Deendayal Upadhyaya's seven principles for social duty: service, balance, self-restraint, coordination, positivity, sensitivity and dialogue.

NCPI MPs

the MPs sought another month.

NCPI MP Kakoli Ghosh Dastidar said, "We have just received the letter. We see that the Speaker has asked us to respond within two weeks. We are collecting all the documents. We will submit our response to the Speaker within the stipulated time. Before that, we will discuss the matter within the party."

Mamata Trinamool Congress MP Kalyan Banerjee said, "The Supreme Court had given four weeks. It had also asked that the Speaker's action be monitored during this period. The Speaker has given two weeks within that timeframe. The NCPI MPs will have to reply within this period. We will announce our next step later."

The Supreme Court on Wednesday heard a petition concerning the disqualification of the 20 MPs and called for an early resolution of the matter, without issuing a specific direction.

Abhishek Banerjee had separately approached the Speaker on June 18 seeking disqualification of the 20 MPs. After no decision was taken, he moved the Supreme Court, which issued notices on August 25 to the MPs, the Speaker and the Lok Sabha Secretary General. Subsequently, the Lok Sabha Secretariat issued notices to the MPs seeking their response.

Brij Bhushan's acquittal

The plea, filed on Friday, also challenges the acquittal of former WFI assistant secretary Vinod Tomar, who was cleared of a criminal intimidation charge. The petition describes

the August 3 magisterial court order as "erroneous and unsustainable in law".

The matter is likely to come up before Special Judge Dig Vinay Singh on Saturday.

Singh, a former BJP MP, was acquitted in a case filed by six women wrestlers, including World Championships medalist Vinesh Phogat. The magisterial court cleared him of charges under IPC Sections 354, 354A and 506(I), while Tomar was acquitted under Section 506(I).

In its 239-page judgment, the court said there was insufficient evidence to establish the allegations. It noted that two complainants had said they were "forced/pressured" to make allegations against Singh and later told the court that no sexual harassment had occurred.

The court also questioned inconsistencies in accounts of the alleged incidents, including references to the "wrong country and year". It said the contradiction affected the prosecution case.

The judgment further noted that the complainants had cited concerns about their careers for not reporting the alleged incidents promptly, while continuing to maintain "cordial relations" with Singh and inviting him to family functions and weddings.

The sessions court will now consider the challenge to the acquittals.

CBSE

cadre, is currently working as Principal Secretary to the Lieutenant Governor of Jammu and Kashmir.

The Appointments Committee of the Cabinet has approved Bhandari's appointment as the CBSE chairperson, an order issued by the personnel ministry said.

Senior IAS officer Lokhande Prashant Sitaram had additional charge of the post.

On July 2 this year, Sitaram was appointed an Additional Secretary in the Union Home Ministry, holding additional charge as the CBSE chairperson. Incidentally, he was appointed as the CBSE chief on June 2 after the incumbent was shunted out amid the On-Screen Marking system row.

Vipin Kumar, Chairman of the Airports Authority of India, has been named as Additional Secretary, Department of Rural Development, the personnel ministry's order said.

Srikant Nagulapalli, Director General of Hydrocarbons, will now be Additional Secretary, Department of Expenditure.

V Ponnuraj, a 2000 batch IAS officer of Karnataka cadre, has been appointed Director General of Hydrocarbons in place of Nagulapalli.

Sarita Chauhan Chand, Additional Secretary in the Depart-

ment of Administrative Reforms and Public Grievances, has been appointed as Additional Secretary and Financial Advisor, Ministry of Steel.Senior bureaucrat Anand Singh will be Additional Secretary, Department of Economic Affairs; P Hemalatha will be Additional Secretary, Department of Personnel and Training; and Piyush Singh will be Additional Secretary, Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare, has been named as Additional Secretary, Department of Higher Education.

Manisha Sensarma will be Additional Secretary, Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship, the order said.

AFSPA

In Manipur, the "disturbed area" declaration will continue across the state, except for areas under 13 police stations in five districts. In Nagaland, the extension covers nine districts, including Dimapur, Mon and Phek, besides areas under 21 police stations in five other districts.

In Arunachal Pradesh, the order covers Tirap, Changlang and Longding districts, along with areas under Namsai, Mahadevpur and Chowkham police stations in Namsai district.

The notifications were issued under Section 3 of the AFSPA, which allows the Centre to declare specified areas as "disturbed areas".

Suruchi, Kamaljeet

seat in a bypoll.

Nagaland recorded 32 cases, all involving MLAs. Most were linked to a political realignment involving the ruling Nationalist Democratic Progressive Party (NDPP) and the Naga People's Front (NPF). The NPF emerged as the largest recipient of lawmakers, with 32 members joining the party. Of those who switched, 25 had originally been elected from the NDPP.

West Bengal recorded 20 cases, all involving Lok Sabha members. All 20 were elected on All India Trinamool Congress (AITC) tickets before moving to the Nationalist Citizens Party of India (NCPI). The MPs have claimed a merger with NCPI, and the matter is currently before Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla.

Telangana recorded nine cases, all involving MLAs elected from the Bharat Rashtra Samithi (BRS), with the Congress receiving the largest number of lawmakers. Goa and Punjab recorded eight cases each. In Goa, Congress MLAs moved to the BJP, while Punjab's cases involved six Rajya Sabha members and two MLAs.

Maharashtra recorded six

cases, involving Lok Sabha members elected from Shiv Sena (Uddhav Balasaheb Thackeray) who later moved to the Shiv Sena led by Eknath Shinde. Meghalaya recorded six MLA cases and Manipur five. Arunachal Pradesh and Gujarat had four each, while Himachal Pradesh and Rajasthan recorded two each. Karnataka, Madhya Pradesh, Sikkim, Uttar Pradesh and Delhi had one case each.

At the party level, NDPP recorded the highest number of exits at 25, followed by AITC with 20 and Congress with 19. BRS had nine, AAP and NCP seven each, Shiv Sena (Uddhav Balasaheb Thackeray) six, JD(U) five and NPP four. The three largest sources, NDPP, AITC and Congress, accounted for 64 cases, or 58 per cent. The NPF received 32 lawmakers, followed by BJP with 29 and NCPI with 20. Together, the three parties accounted for 81 cases, or 73 per cent.

ADR said defections had been linked to the fall of governments in some states. It also said its findings may not be exhaustive because there is no systematically maintained official database of lawmakers changing parties.

The watchdog has proposed changes to the anti-defection framework, including shifting decisions on disqualification petitions from presiding officers to the President for MPs and governors for MLAs, based on Election Commission advice.

It has also called for fixed timelines for such decisions and restrictions on defectors holding public office until they are re-elected.

ECI adds 'VIP'

An official at Delhi's chief electoral office noted that such directives originate solely from the commission itself, not local offices. Field officers in Delhi and Haryana confirmed the tool was active on their devices, while counterparts in West Bengal said it had been absent when that state's revision began in November 2025, only appearing roughly a month before HT's report.

The rollout follows scrutiny over discrepancy notices sent to high-profile Delhi residents, among them Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, former Chief Minister Arvind Kejriwal, ex-deputy prime minister L K Advani, and External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar. Officials clarified that flagging voters as VIP, a practice dating to 2018 guidelines, speeds up processing but does not shield them from such notices.

Separately, poll panel data released Friday showed 3.27 crore voters aged 18 to 28 had joined the rolls since Bihar's revision began last June.

Briefs

Eknath Shinde to visit Manipur

IMPHAL: Maharashtra Deputy Chief Minister Eknath Shinde is likely to visit Manipur in October to conduct bhoomi puja before reconstructing a temple destroyed in ethnic violence in the state where his faction of the Shiv Sena will contest the assembly polls due next year, party leaders said on Friday.

The Eknath Shinde-led Shiv Sena's Manipur unit president M Tombi Singh said the Maharashtra leader agreed to conduct the bhoomi puja at Koubru Leikha Temple following a request from them.

Shah likely to visit Mizoram on October 5

AIZAWL: Union Home minister Amit Shah is likely to visit Mizoram on October 5 and inaugurate various projects, state government officials said on Friday. Although the full itinerary is yet to be received, preparations are underway for Shah's visit, they said.

The home minister is expected to inaugurate various projects, including those under the state cooperation department during his visit, the officials said.

US cyber fraud: Key accused held

NEW DELHI: The Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) has arrested a key accused in a transnational cyber-enabled financial fraud that involved illegal call centres in Ahmedabad and targeted users in the US.

The accused Ankit Satishchandra Pandey was arrested on September 23, a day after the CBI registered a case against him and other unnamed persons on September 8 in connection with the alleged fraud.

J&K: 220 eye surgeries under Army

SRINAGAR: Doctors from the Armed Forces Medical Services (AFMS) carried out over 200 sight-restoring surgeries during a two-day camp near the Line of Control (LoC) in Jammu and Kashmir's Kupwara district, an official spokesman said on Friday.

Most procedures were cataract surgeries, along with selective retinal procedures and minimally invasive glaucoma surgery, he said.

TN: Facilities inaugurated at BSF camp

CHENNAI: Union Minister of State for Home Affairs Bandi Sanjay Kumar on Friday inaugurated new facilities for BSF personnel at its Keerapakkam camp near here, saying they would improve their working and living conditions. The facilities, established at a cost of Rs 30.97 crore, will provide personnel with improved spaces to work, live and rest, he said.

‘MAKE IN INDIA’ PROGRAM WAS LAUNCHED IN 2014

PM Modi lauds ‘Make in India’ success, credits infra, innovation

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 25

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Friday highlighted the success of his government's ‘Make in India’ initiative, and said creation of infrastructure, enterprise and innovation allows the country to prosper.

The ‘Make in India’ programme was launched on September 25, 2014 with the ambition of making India a global hub for manufacturing, design and innovation.

“More made in India. More investment in India. More exports from India. A transformation visible across sectors. ‘Make in India’ is about creating infrastructure, enterprise and innovation that allow India to grow and prosper,” he said in a post on X.

The Prime Minister also posted a video on his social media handles showcasing the success India achieved in semiconductor industry, aerospace, train engines and coach manufacturing, ship building, metro networks, automobile, medicines, solar power, mobile phone making among others.

The ‘Make in India’ initiative is focused on facilitating investment, fostering innovation and developing world-class infrastructure.

Guided by ‘Minimum Government, Maximum



Prime Minister Narendra Modi

PTI

KEY POINTS

- » The ‘Make in India’ initiative is focused on facilitating investment, fostering innovation and developing world-class infrastructure
- » Over the years, ‘Make in India’ has opened new opportunities for businesses and investors to participate in India’s manufacturing journey
- » ‘More made in India. More investment in India. More exports from India. A transformation visible across sectors’

Governance’, it has also sought to modernise processes and policies.

Over the years, ‘Make in India’ has opened new opportunities for businesses and investors to

participate in India’s manufacturing journey.

The initiative has subsequently been expanded under ‘Make in India 2.0’. The initiative now focuses on 27 sectors, which

include 15 in manufacturing and 12 in services.

Meanwhile, Interacting with participants of ‘Seva Yatra’, Prime Minister Modi on Friday asserted that the gap between cities and villages in India has significantly narrowed in the last 12 years. Modi also said that ever since his government came to power in 2014, self-reliance has increased among the women of the country.

“Over the past 12 years, the gap between cities and villages in India has significantly narrowed. Today, infrastructure in villages has improved significantly,” he said.

EC clarification sought by 3 NDA allies

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 25

Three BJP allies -- LJP (Ram Vilas), TDP and RLM -- on Friday sought a clearer explanation from the Election Commission regarding concerns raised by two Election Commissioners over the voter list revision, with Union minister Chirag Paswan warning that public faith in elections was at stake.

Paswan, who heads the Lok Janshakti Party (Ram Vilas), said he was neither speaking for the poll panel nor endorsing the Opposition's allegations. But the questions now before the public required a clearer response from the Commission, he said.

RLM chief Uppendra Kushwaha also called for an immediate clarification, while TDP's Lok Sabha floor leader Lavu Srikrishna Devarayalu said transparency would help strengthen confidence in the constitutional institution.

Parl friendship groups: MPs express disappointment over ‘inaction’

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 25

Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla constituted Parliamentary friendship groups for more than 60 countries in February in a step seen as significant to enhance inter-Parliamentary engagement with the world. However, no meeting of the groups has taken place in the last seven months.

Many MPs appointed to these groups have expressed their disappointment over the inaction, hoping that meaningful steps would be taken in this regard.

Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) MP Sanjay Singh, chairperson of the India-Suriname friendship group, told news agency, “I was made the chairperson in February. But nothing happened after that. No meeting took place. There has been no correspondence regarding future activities either.”

The friendship groups for about 60 countries were

Amit Shah says UP on course to become USD 1 trillion economy

‘UP coming up as big investment, manufacturing hub’

NARESH BISWANI
Greater Noida, September 25

Union Home minister Amit Shah on Friday said that Uttar Pradesh was coming up as a big investment and manufacturing hub and was confident that it would achieve its target of a USD 1 trillion economy.

The Home minister was addressing the gathering on the occasion of inauguration of the fourth edition of Uttar Pradesh International Trade Show (UPITS) in Greater Noida in the presence of Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath and other dignitaries.

Shah said that the trade show was being held on the 12th anniversary of ‘Make in India’ initiative launched by Prime Minister Narendra Modi on September 25, 2014.

He said that this initiative had laid a strong foundation for India to emerge as a global production, design and innovation hub.

The Home minister



said that Uttar Pradesh had plenty of land, water, skilled artisans and a positive industrial environment conducive to investments which would help the state to achieve its goal of a USD 1 trillion economy.

Referring to the previous editions of UPITS, Shah said that first edition depicted the transformation that Uttar Pradesh was undergoing, the second one generated investment intent and the third one brought the investors on board and now the fourth edition was going to usher in partnerships to take the

state to a USD 1 trillion economy.

Shah said that the 2025 trade fair witnessed more than five lakh visitors, over 2,400 MoUs were signed and thousands of crores of investment commitments were made.

He was confident that the 2026 edition of UPITS would see these numbers crossed.

On defence manufacturing, he said that Uttar Pradesh was becoming a key player in this segment with six nodes of defence corridor in Jhansi, Chitrakoot, Lucknow, Agra, Aligarh and Kanpur.

ON OBC REPRESENTATION, WELFARE IN PSUs

Parl panel to meet Central ministries

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 25

A Parliamentary panel on welfare of Other Backward Classes has decided to meet representatives of various ministries to discuss measures taken by them to secure employment of OBCs in PSUs and various government departments.

According to an official Lok Sabha bulletin issued on Friday, the Parliamentary Committee on Welfare of Other Backward Classes (2026’ 27) has selected 33 subjects across key Union ministries and departments for examination.

The 30-member committee is chaired by BJP MP Ganesh Singh and includes

parliamentarians such as Gurjeet Singh Aujla, and Manickam Tagore, Ramvir Singh Bidhuri among others.

The panel, in its upcoming meetings, will review the representation of OBCs in public sector undertakings (PSUs), central universities, financial institutions, defence forces, and government services.

‘Cong leaders may visit SP strongholds coming days’

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Lucknow, September 25

A day after Akhilesh Yadav visited Rahul Gandhi's Lok Sabha constituency Raebareli, Uttar Pradesh Congress chief Ajay Rai on Friday said people are free to visit any part of the country and that Congress leaders too may visit the Samajwadi Party strongholds of Etawah, Kannauj and Mainpuri over the coming days.

“Anyone is free to visit any part of the country. He (Yadav) visited Raebareli, and there was nothing wrong in it. We too will surely visit places like Varanasi, or for that matter, Etawah, Kannauj and Mainpuri,” Rai told news agency.

On Thursday, Samajwadi Party chief boarded a specially designed ‘PDA Rath’, his mount of choice to bounce back from two successive electoral reverses he faced at the hands of the BJP, for a visit to Raebareli.

As part of his campaign for next year's Uttar Pradesh elections, Yadav is set to travel across the state on the ‘PDA Rath’ to connect with the politically influential ‘Pichhda (backwards), Dalit and Alpsankhyak (minority)’ voters - the social coalition that has become a central plank of the SP's strategy.

Yadav is the Lok Sabha MP from Kannauj, his wife Dimple is the Mainpuri MP, while his uncle Shivalp is the MLA from the Jaswantnagar Assembly segment in Etawah.

The BJP on Thursday took potshots at Yadav's Raebareli visit, claiming that it was undertaken to demonstrate SP's political strength in the constituency and question the Congress' position there.

‘U’khand: Small agroforests could shrink up to 70% by 2050’

The decreases are most evident in mid-elevation zones and rain-fed agroforestry regions

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 25

Uttarakhand could see up to a 70 per cent decline in its smaller agroforestry patches, while larger farm hills might show a moderate 10-20 per cent reduction by 2050 under continued climate warming, according to research.

The decreases are most evident in mid-elevation zones and rain-fed agroforestry regions, where climatic stress is expected to intensify, findings published in the journal Discover Forests reveal.

Researchers from Dehradun's Doon University and Indian Council of Agricultural Research (ICAR)-Central Agroforestry Research Institute in Jhansi, Uttar Pradesh analysed satellite images and field surveys to map agroforestry in the state today and what could happen to it by 2050.

“Results show that mid-altitudinal zones offer the highest suitability for agroforestry expansion, whereas small and fragmented systems exhibit reduced climate resilience under future projections,” the authors wrote.

CLOSER LOOK

- » The researchers found 105 distinct tree and 82 crop species, demonstrating a ‘high floristic richness’
- » Changes in temperature, precipitation and extreme events can alter tree and crop species’ composition and ecosystems, the team said

They said agroforestry systems -- increasingly recognised for their role in adapting to and mitigating climate change -- are vulnerable to effects of global warming.

The researchers found 105 distinct tree and 82 crop

species, demonstrating a “high floristic richness”.

Changes in temperature, precipitation and extreme events can alter tree and crop species’ composition and ecosystems, the team said.

The systems are par-

ticularly important in the Indian Himalayan Region, where steep slopes, fragmented landholdings, and climatic variability can challenge conventional agriculture, the researchers said.

The region too has been found to be highly vulnerable and sensitive to climate change, with long-term observations showing trends of increases in temperature, altered precipitation patterns and elevation-dependent warming.

Mid-altitude zones between 1,100 metres and

1,600 metres in elevation and characterised by 20-30 degree slopes were found to be highly suitable for agroforestry expansion -- about 150 square kilometres in area.

Over 525 square kilometres of area was identified as ‘moderately suitable’ for hill farm expansion comprising under 10 degree slopes and between 1,600-2,100 metres elevation and characterised by moderate rainfall. Land less than 600 metres or above 2,100 metres in elevation was classified as least suitable for expansion.

MONSOON FURY CONTINUES

Rain, floods disrupt life across several states; UP steps up vigil

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, September 25

Heavy rain and flooding disrupted life across several states on Friday, with nearly 50.5 lakh people affected by floods in Bihar, around 10,000 people evacuated to relief centres in Odisha, and roads, rail services, power supply and air connectivity hit in parts of Jharkhand and Chhattisgarh. Uttar Pradesh, meanwhile, stepped up preparedness as the India Meteorological Department forecast heavy to very heavy rain over the next two days.

In Uttar Pradesh, the IMD warned of heavy to very heavy rainfall at several places, with extremely heavy rain possible at isolated locations. The state government put district administrations on alert for heavy rain, thunderstorms and lightning till September 27, particularly in areas vulnerable to waterlogging and flooding.

The administration warned that intense rainfall could trigger flash floods in some watersheds. Strong surface winds of 30-40 kmph, with gusts of around 50 kmph, are also likely, while isolated areas could experience gusts of 40-50 kmph reaching 60 kmph.

In Bihar, around 50.49 lakh people have been affected by floods across 15 districts, covering 576 gram panchayats in 88 blocks. The Kosi is flowing above the danger mark at Baltara, while the Bagmati is above the warning level at Son-



Motorcyclists waded through a flooded section of NH 30 following heavy rainfall at Dimrapal, in Jagdalpur, Bastar district, Friday

INSIGHT

- » 10K people evacuated in Odisha
- » Nearly 50.5L people affected by floods in Bihar
- » Power and transport services hit in parts of Jharkhand & Chhattisgarh

akhan and Benibad.

The Water Resources Department ordered round-the-clock vigilance along vulnerable stretches of the Gandak and Kosi, including embankments, sluice gates and low-lying areas. Officials have been asked to conduct night patrolling and report seepage, overtopping, erosion or breaches. As many as 222 boats have been deployed for evacuation and movement, while 27 SDRF and eight NDRF teams remain deployed.

In Odisha, heavy rain caused rivers to swell, landslides, waterlogging and damage to houses. Around

10,000 people from low-lying and landslide-prone areas in southern and western parts of the state were shifted to 200 relief centres.

At least 24 places recorded more than 100 mm rainfall in 24 hours. Tentulikhunti received 395 mm, Nandahandi 344 mm and Boriguma 307.8 mm. The Jalaka, Budhabalanga, Baitarani and Kani rivers crossed danger marks.

Landslides blocked roads in Gajapati and Malkangiri, while boulders fell on NH-16 at Bada Ghati. In Kandhamal, a landslide at Kalinga Ghat brought down nearly 200 metres of a guard wall.

Landslides on railway tracks affected train services in Rayagada division.

Jharkhand also witnessed direct disruption from incessant rain, with trees and electricity poles uprooted, affecting traffic and power supply. In Ranchi, a tree fell on a school bus carrying children, though all students were rescued safely. Several schools declared holidays and all schools from kindergarten to Class 12 were ordered closed on Saturday. At least 24 flights were cancelled at Birsamunda Airport, while several areas experienced prolonged power outages.

In Chhattisgarh, heavy rain inundated low-lying areas, swelled rivers and cut off remote settlements in Bastar. A 40-year-old farmer drowned in Kondagaon after falling into a flooded drain while catching fish in a partially submerged paddy field.

MP: CM SUGAM BUS, PM E-BUS SEVAS LAUNCHED

Flex-fuel vehicles running on 100% ethanol to be introduced: Gadkari

SATYAPRAKASH SHARMA

Bhopal, September 25

Amid the ongoing debate over E20 fuel, Union Minister for Road Transport and Highways Nitin Gadkari on Friday said that India will soon introduce flex-fuel-engine vehicles capable of running on 100 per cent ethanol. He said the move would help reduce fuel import costs, curb pollution and increase farmers' income.

Addressing a state-level programme in Bhopal, Gadkari said all automobile companies would prepare vehicles with flex-fuel engines in which ethanol could be used as the sole fuel.

"Country's farmers will produce ethanol from maize," Gadkari said, underlining the potential



of alternative fuels to create an economically self-reliant model. He said the farmer was now becoming an "energy provider" in addition to being an "annadata".

Gadkari said India imports petrol, diesel and gas worth around Rs 22 lakh crore annually, while ethanol-blended fuel introduced in 2022 is now used in around four crore four-wheelers and 20 crore

two-wheelers.

The minister also advocated electric and alternative fuels, calling for affordable electric AC buses and noting that hydrogen-powered buses were being introduced on 10 routes.

Gadkari's remarks came during the launch of the Madhya Pradesh government's Mukhyamantri Sugam Parivahan Seva and PM E-Bus Seva in Bhopal. Gadkari, Chief Minister

Mohan Yadav and Transport Minister Uday Pratap Singh flagged off 351 inter-city and intracity buses for seven cities, marking the revival of public transport services in the state after 21 years.

Speaking at the event, CM Yadav said the launch marked a new chapter in fulfilling the government's commitment to public service. He said the public transport service would also benefit people living in remote tribal areas.

Yadav said the new service would provide modern transport facilities for the poor and needy, with buses equipped with CCTV cameras, panic buttons, emergency doors, GPS monitoring and online ticketing, along with passenger grievance and driver-training mechanisms.

Haryana CM asks officials to expedite construction of Anganwadi buildings

MPOST BUREAU

Chandigarh, September 25

Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Friday directed officials to expedite construction of dedicated buildings for Anganwadi centres operating from rented premises and identify suitable government land, vacant school spaces and other locations for the purpose.

Chairing a review meeting of the Women and Child Development Department, Saini stressed optimum use

of available resources and coordinated efforts by officials and public representatives to create permanent facilities.

Reviewing the Mahila Evam Kishori Samman Yojana, he directed officials to provide quality sanitary pads free of cost to eligible BPL women and adolescent girls, while ensuring proper beneficiary registration and distribution records. He also ordered wider availability of sanitary products through Jan Aushadhi Kendras, schools and designated

centres, besides installing dispensing machines wherever required.

UNDER MISSION SE PURI COPY KAT DIJIYE AUR YE CHIPKA DIJIYE-- Saini directed that the Juvenile Justice Fund be raised to Rs 10 crore and solar panels installed at Children's Homes. He ordered their renovation and regular inspection. He also directed that financial assistance to victims of sexual and POCSO-related offences be increased from Rs 20,000 to Rs 50,000.

Hooda demands CEC Kumar's resignation

MPOST BUREAU

Chandigarh, September 25

Thousands of Haryana Congress workers and leaders protested outside the State Election Commission office on Friday, alleging irregularities in the electoral process.

Police used barricades and water cannons to stop protesters attempting to gherao the office, with Congress claiming several workers were injured and many detained. The protest was led by state in-charge Sanjay Dutt, former chief minister Bhupinder Singh Hooda and state president Rao Narendra.

Hooda alleged that public trust in the Election Commission had eroded and demanded CEC Gyanesh Kumar's resignation. He cited discrepancies in Haryana's reported voter turnout and alleged irregularities in voter lists, including multiple registrations linked to single photographs, citing claims earlier made by Rahul Gandhi.

CISF, IHBAS ink pact for personnel's mental health care



MPOST BUREAU

New Delhi, September 25

The CISF on Friday signed a three-year MoU with the Institute of Human Behaviour and Allied Sciences (IHBAS) to strengthen psychological wellness, stress management and clinical mental health support for its personnel.

The agreement was signed by CISF IG (Administration) Pratibha Agarwal and IHBAS Professor and Head of Clinical Psychology Dr Vibha Sharma, in the presence of CISF DG Praveer Ranjan and IHBAS Director Dr Rajinder K Dhamija, who joined through video conference.

Under the partnership, IHBAS will conduct specialised psychometric assessments of personnel deployed in sensitive units, including those proposed for deployment at the Parliament House Complex.

The collaboration will focus on early detection of behavioural warning signs, acute stress and psychiatric emergencies, besides training CISF medical and supervisory personnel for timely intervention.

IHBAS will also provide psychiatric evaluation and treatment, including alcohol dependence services, through its outpatient and inpatient facilities. Training-of-trainers programmes will create CISF mental-health master trainers.

Briefs

NFR steps up parcel security

MALIGAON: North-east Frontier Railway has begun installing modern parcel cages at seven stations, including New Jalpaiguri, Siliguri, Kishanganj, Haldibari, Malda Court, Balurghat and Katihar. Work is underway at four stations, with the facilities aimed at improving parcel security, storage, handling efficiency and preventing consignments from being misplaced.

Manipur: 4 bodies found

IMPHAL: Bullet-ridden bodies of four men were recovered from Manipur's Kamjong district in the early hours of Friday, with police suspecting that militants from Myanmar were behind the killings. The deceased belonged to the Tangkhul Naga community.

UP doctors urged to use Hindi

LUCKNOW: Uttar Pradesh Deputy CM Brajesh Pathak has urged doctors to write medicine names in Hindi or Devanagari on prescriptions and communicate with patients in local languages where possible. He cited Bhojpuri, Awadhi and Braj, saying simpler communication would improve patients' understanding, confidence and access to healthcare.

Punjab emerging as 'major industrial hub'

MPOST BUREAU

Chandigarh, September 25

Punjab is fast emerging as a major industrial hub and preferred investment destination, with the Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann-led government attracting Rs 1.89 lakh crore in investments over the last four years, an official statement said here on Friday.

This generated employment potential for 6.31 lakh youth and is driving industrial growth beyond traditional centres, it said.

With Mohali leading new investment proposals at Rs 9,478 crore, followed by Ludhiana at Rs 4,968 crore, the expanding investment footprint reflects growing investor confidence while opening new avenues for jobs, entrepreneurship and higher incomes across Punjab, the statement said.

It said that on Friday, Chief Minister Mann reviewed the progress of the Industries Department here.

'MANN GOVT ATTRACTED RS 1.89L CRORE IN INVESTMENTS OVER THE LAST 4 YEARS'

The statement, quoting Mann, said, "The remarkable scale of investment reflects the growing confidence of domestic and global investors in Punjab's industrial ecosystem. Our government has consistently worked to create a congenial, transparent and investor-friendly business environment, backed by improved infrastructure, responsive governance and streamlined approvals."

The chief minister said Punjab's traditional strengths in agriculture, manufacturing, engineering, textiles and food processing, coupled with the state's emerging capabilities in technology, renewable energy, automobiles and modern manufacturing, are providing a strong foundation for the next phase of industrial growth.

Prez accepts credentials of 6 envoys

MPOST BUREAU

New Delhi, September 25

President Droupadi Murmu on Friday accepted the credentials of envoys from Finland, Vietnam, Mexico, Estonia, the European Union and Belgium at a ceremony at Rashtrapati Bhavan.

The Ambassadors who presented the credentials were Mikko Kivikoski (Finland), Trinh Minh Manh (Vietnam), Pedro Blanco Pérez (Mexico), Kristi Karelsohn (Estonia), Jean-Eric Paquet (European Union) and Sophie Karlshausen (Belgium).



Saini reviews bajra, paddy procurement arrangements

MPOST BUREAU

Chandigarh, September 25

Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Friday chaired a review meeting over the procurement of bajra and paddy crops.

He also gave necessary directions to officials regarding area verification under Meri Fasal-Mera Byora, registration of rice millers, arrangements required at mandis for the procurement of bajra and paddy, and setting up additional

procurement centres as per requirement.

Saini said farmers in Haryana will be ensured a payment of Rs 2,900 per quintal for bajra under the 'Bhavantar Bharpai Yojana'.

An official statement said, "Saini directed officials to strictly curb attempts to bring bajra from other states and sell it in Haryana".

Saini said bajra is being sold at a much lower price in neighbouring states compared to Haryana. Therefore, strict action would be taken

against attempts to bring bajra from neighbouring states into Haryana for sale.

He directed that, with the assistance of the district administration and police, it should be ensured at the borders of neighbouring states that bajra from other states does not enter Haryana. Officials informed the chief minister that last year, the government had initially fixed the procurement rate for bajra at Rs 2,150 per quintal and later increased it to Rs 2,200 per quintal.

From first battalion to frontlines: 40 years of CRPF women warriors

Women warriors participate in counter-insurgency ops, law-and-order duties & other key assignments

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, September 25

The Central Reserve Police Force (CRPF) on Friday marked four decades of women warriors in its ranks, commemorating the raising of its first women's combat battalion in 1986.

A function was organised at the Shaurya Officers' Institute in New Delhi, attended by CRPF Director General G P Singh, senior officials, women veterans, serving personnel and distinguished guests.

Director General (DG) Singh and Anamika Singh, president of the CRPF Family Welfare Association



CRPF women veterans, serving personnel and others during a function at the Shaurya Officers' Institute in New Delhi

(CWA), unfurled the flag during the event. The DG paid tribute to women personnel, felicitated veterans and acknowledged the

sacrifices made by women members of the force and their families.

He said the contribution of women warriors

to the CRPF had been steadily expanding, with women personnel playing important roles in counter-insurgency operations, law-and-order duties and other assignments.

He said the force would continue working to cre-

ate more opportunities for women personnel to contribute and develop their careers.

The CRPF also expressed its gratitude to the families of personnel who have supported them through challenging

operations. Singh highlighted the CWA's initiatives aimed at supporting CRPF families.

The force described the 88th Mahila Battalion, raised in 1986, as a pioneer in the deployment of women personnel. Since then, women have participated in major assignments involving counter-terrorism, riot control, VIP security, anti-Naxal operations and United Nations peace-keeping missions.

According to the CRPF, women personnel have also received gallantry and distinguished service medals for their contributions while serving in chal-

lenging areas across the country.

The force said women have served in diverse roles, including as constables, drivers, clerks and account assistants, besides other responsibilities. In recent years, their deployment has expanded to difficult operational areas, making them an integral part of the country's internal security framework.

The 40-year milestone highlighted the expanding role of women in the CRPF and their contribution across different operational and support assignments, the force said.

KEY POINTS

- » The CRPF on Friday marked four decades of women warriors in its ranks, commemorating the raising of its first women's combat battalion in 1986
- » Director General G P Singh said the contribution of women warriors to the CRPF had been steadily expanding
- » The force described the 88th Mahila Battalion, raised in 1986, as a pioneer in the deployment of women personnel

EDITORIAL

Normalcy Remains Elusive

The Centre’s decision to extend the “disturbed area” status under the Armed Forces (Special Powers) Act (AFSPA) across most of Manipur for another six months is an acknowledgement of an uncomfortable reality: normalcy remains elusive. Effective October 1, the declaration covers the entire state except areas under 13 police stations across five districts. The notification follows a review of the law-and-order situation and will remain in force for six months unless withdrawn earlier.

The immediate security argument is difficult to dismiss. Manipur has not emerged from its cycle of violence, and recent developments have made the fragility painfully evident. Violence that began principally between Meitei and Kuki-Zo communities in May 2023 has since acquired additional fault lines. Human Rights Watch reported earlier this month that renewed clashes involving Naga and Kuki-Zo communities had killed at least seven people in late August, while more than 260 people had been killed and over 60,000 displaced since the violence erupted in 2023. Fresh violence has continued this week, including killings near the Myanmar border and the burning of houses in Kangpokpi.

In such circumstances, withdrawing extraordinary security provisions simply to manufacture an appearance of normalcy would be irresponsible. The state must retain the capacity to protect civilians, secure vulnerable areas, recover illegal weapons and prevent armed groups from exploiting administrative weakness. But extending AFSPA cannot itself become a substitute for restoring ordinary governance. An emergency provision may create operational space for security forces; it cannot rebuild trust between communities, return displaced families home or repair the political relationships shattered by more than three years of conflict.

That distinction matters. Six-month extensions risk becoming bureaucratic punctuation marks in an unresolved crisis unless every renewal is accompanied by measurable progress towards making the next one unnecessary. The geographical footprint of AFSPA should therefore remain under rigorous review, with areas removed whenever objective security conditions permit. The Supreme Court has previously required periodic review of “disturbed area” declarations, underscoring that exceptional powers cannot be treated as an ordinary and permanent condition of administration.

Manipur needs something considerably more ambitious than another security timetable. It requires sustained political engagement across communities, credible policing, prosecution of serious crimes, rehabilitation of displaced people, restoration of movement between divided areas and an institutional mechanism capable of addressing competing grievances without allowing violence to become their language. Security operations can suppress immediate threats; only politics can resolve the conditions that continually reproduce them.

The real test for New Delhi, therefore, is not whether it can justify AFSPA for another six months. Given the present security situation, it has stated its grounds for doing so. The harder test is whether these six months will leave Manipur safer, less segregated and closer to ordinary constitutional governance. Extraordinary powers are defensible only as a bridge back to normal law. If every bridge ends at another extension, Manipur will remain trapped in an emergency without an exit.

LETTER



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Digital Diplomacy

The willingness of the US and China to discuss cooperation on artificial intelligence is encouraging. As AI becomes increasingly powerful, rivalry must not overshadow the need for safeguards. Dialogue between the two technological giants can help address misuse, improve accountability and ensure innovation ultimately remains centred on human welfare.

ANIRBAN DUTTA,
KOLKATA

You can also send your comments to The Editor, Millennium Post, Pratap Bhawan, 5 Bahadur Shah Zafar Marg, New Delhi 110 002

Rajdharma as a Governing Ideal

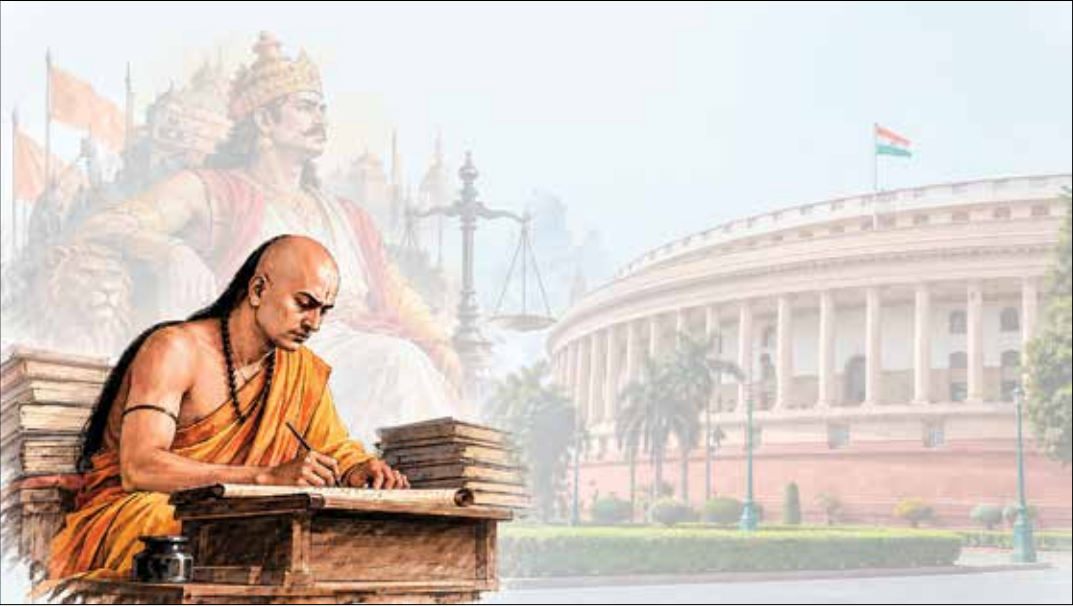
From Vedic philosophy to Kautilya’s statecraft, Rajdharma placed public welfare, ethical restraint and accountability at the heart of legitimate political authority and governance

REPUBLICAN ETHOS



JOHN FELIX RAJ &
PRABHAT KUMAR DATTA

JF RAJ IS THE VC, PK DATTA IS
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In Rajdharma, political authority remains inseparable from duty

Rajdharma may be conceptualised as the Dharma of governance—the duties, ethical imperatives, and moral obligations binding a ruler or ruling class. In the ancient Indian tradition, Rajdharma functions as a charter of royal obligations, a system of institutional and moral restraints, and an ethical framework governing the exercise of power.

Unlike classical European statecraft models that prioritise absolute sovereignty or administrative control, Rajdharma views authority as a sacred trust. The state is a custodian of justice, public welfare, security, and social order. Governance, therefore, must be designed to secure the safety, material prosperity, and holistic well-being of the populace—guided by the classic maxim: *Praja hite hitam rajnah, praja sukhe sukham rajyam* (“In the happiness of the subjects lies the king’s happiness; in their welfare, his welfare”).

Rajdharma demands rigorous self-discipline, truthfulness, impartial justice, compassion, political courage, and administrative wisdom. Within this paradigm, legitimacy to rule is derived not merely from a proce-

dural mandate, but from unwavering fidelity to public welfare.

Vedic Foundation and Philosophical Framework

The Vedic tradition emphasises a cosmic order governing both the physical universe and the divine realm. The *Atharva Veda* explicitly distinguishes *Rita* (cosmic order, truth, and harmony) from *Dharma*. Although historical trajectories gradually entwined religious practice with *Dharma*, the conceptual core of *Dharma* remains distinct from institutionalised religion. Unlike ritualistic religion, *Dharma* is a comprehensive philosophical construct—a dynamic framework for righteous living, social cohesion, and cosmic balance.

Rajdharma in the Mahabharata
The *Mahabharata* conceptualises Rajdharma as the foundation of a normative state dedicated to upholding justice and the public good. In the *Shanti Parva*, it is explicitly established that political power is attained and sustained through *Dharma*, which rulers must actively embody in their actions.

The *Shanti Parva* presents a profound philosophical narrative regarding the cyclical degeneration of *Dharma* across the ages (*Yugas*), positioning *Rajd-*

RAJDHARMA IS ABOUT THE MORAL BOUNDARIES WITHIN WHICH POWER COULD LEGITIMATELY BE EXERCISED

harma as the primary stabilising force of society. A ruler possesses the agency to shape their era—ushering in a golden age (*Krita Yuga*) or causing moral and social chaos—depending entirely on their adherence to *Dharma*. This principle is echoed in the *Sukraniti*, which characterises the ruler as the promoter and maker of his age (*Raja kalasya karanam*). In times of moral degeneration, unrestrained desires precipitate social chaos, threatening life and property.

Grounded in the *Rigveda* and elaborated in the *Shanti Parva*, the ruler maintains order through *Dandaniti*—the judicial use of authority and enforcement (*Danda*) to preserve justice. The protection of the populace

(*Janapada*) stands as the ruler’s highest obligation, a principle reinforced in the *Manusmriti* as the supreme *Dharma*.

This framework synthesises three essential dimensions: political philosophy, jurisprudence, and ethical theology. Comparable to Plato’s vision of a stratified, functional society—comprising farmers, guardians, and philosopher-kings—the *Rajdharma* framework emphasises the functional division of responsibility to achieve enduring social harmony.

Kautilya’s Formulation of Rajdharma

In the *Arthashastra*, Kautilya formulates *Rajdharma* as a synthesis of state power and institutional responsibility. He asserts that a ruler secures political legitimacy primarily through the pursuit of *Yogakshema* for the people. Rangarajan analyses *Yogakshema* as a compound of *Yoga* (the successful achievement of an objective) and *Kshema* (its peaceful enjoyment and protection). In Kautilya’s statecraft, *Yogakshema* obligates the state to ensure both the acquisition and preservation of the subjects’ security and economic prosperity.

Kautilya maintains that only a leader who has mastered their

senses (*Indriyavijayi*) can legitimately claim and exercise power. The ultimate aim of good governance is *Sukham* (happiness/well-being), achieved through *Dharma*, which, in turn, flourishes when supported by *Artha* (economic vitality and material security). Kautilya’s distinctive contribution lies in embedding *realpolitik* within the civilisational ethos of the nation, requiring leaders to respectfully engage with historical wisdom while adapting to contemporary realities.

Long before Lord Acton noted the corrupting influence of power, Kautilya recognised this inherent risk in governance and counteracted it through *Maryada* (righteous boundaries and self-restraint). He cautioned rulers against creating distance between themselves and the populace, warning that overreliance on bureaucracy leads to administrative corruption, inefficiency, and public discontent. To prevent moral decay, Kautilya championed two cardinal tenets of modern governance: direct accessibility and systemic accountability.

Contemporary Relevance and Constitutional Resonance

Kautilya’s formulation anticipates key concepts of modern constitutionalism. The Indian Constitution is not merely a legal code, but an expression of foundational values serving as a moral compass for governance. Upendra Baxi interprets the doctrine of the “Basic Structure”—articulated by the Supreme Court in the landmark *Kesavananda Bharati* case—as a modern institutional manifestation of *Rajdharma*. It places substantive moral restraints on sovereign power, ensuring that no branch of government can claim absolute or unbridled authority. Thus, the constitutional framework reflects the timeless essence of *Rajdharma*: authority bound by duty rather than personal desire, and sovereignty limited by the rule of law rather than arbitrary will.

Views expressed are personal

Cutting India’s Compliance Maze

India’s next reform phase must simplify everyday operations and reduce persistent regulatory friction

AT VANTAGE



SHUTAPA PAUL

THE WRITER IS AN AUTHOR
AND MEDIA ENTREPRENEUR

lighted that while 40,000 regulatory steps have been scrapped, several rules still overlap, thereby increasing operational costs for businesses. But here’s where it revealed something that truly deserves more than a cursory look – currently, a typical business negotiates its way through several outdated compliances encased in 1,536 Acts. This also creates a load of 69,233 separate compliances and 6,618 additional statutory filings across three levels of government administration. Also, while the four Labour Codes have simplified matters on the labour front by merging 29 central laws, they may still give rise to further additional compliances when the states get involved with their own lists of rules.

Now, what’s a business to do? It doesn’t help that economic conditions and global outages remain par for the course, and businesses, especially MSMEs (micro, small and medium enterprises), continue to reel from regulatory complexity. The ones that operate in export markets already have tariff laws as well as quality standards and protocols introduced by foreign governments to tackle. Along with that are digital and AI (artificial intelligence) disruptions, with smaller businesses continuously playing catch-up. All in all, the MSME sector finds itself increasingly encumbered and constantly grappling with an endless paper trail.

Here’s what has improved, though – it’s easier and faster to start a business today and also to fold up. I won’t say it’s a quick job yet, but today, things



Regulatory complexity continues to weigh heavily on MSMEs despite years of compliance reform

BUSINESSES FACE MOUNTING COMPLIANCE BURDENS AS CALLS GROW FOR SIMPLER, TRUST-BASED REGULATION

are infinitely less complex than they were before 2020, when the Reducing Compliance Burden (RCB) initiative was introduced (the successor to the Business Reforms Action Plan (BRAP) of 2014). To date, 47,000 compliance requirements have been scrapped or changed, of which 16,108 were made easier, 22,287 were digitised, 4,458 were legalised, and 4,270 were removed due to redundancy. Therefore,

while it’s less daunting to start or wind up a business, the challenges of keeping one running are firmly in place. The cost of compliance increases primarily due to this and adds an additional hurdle for businesses that are anyway fighting through uncertain times.

Stakeholders have apprised the parliamentary committee of the various lags that still exist. For instance, the jurisdictions of several departments overlap, and therefore, businesses often duplicate their costs and efforts while meeting compliance requirements. The demand is for a seamless one-window approach wherein a business can get approvals without running from pillar to post between departments. Unified licensing and inspections would further shrink the time needed to receive licences. The parliamentary committee further recommends that regulatory approvals, licences, permissions, and renewals

should come under the National Single Window System (NSWS) in a time-bound, predictable manner.

To drastically reduce the weight of compliance on businesses, there is also a growing clamour to shift towards trust-based systems that rely on self-certification, third-party accreditations, automatic renewals, and risk-based inspections. This obviously opens up an interesting sub-context too – can we trust our businesses to comply honestly? The Indian business scenario has passed through the Licence Raj and economic liberalisation to the IT and startup booms. We have indeed come a long way, and therefore, our own economic evolution would necessitate that we don’t treat our own with preconceived notions. To foster a business climate of integrity, checks and balances would need to be put in place, a task easily done using technology. But most importantly, the onus would then have to fall on the businesses themselves to be strictly compliant. And to that effect, the prism of treating all businesses as wilful flouters of regulations must change. Because for all those who do operate in grey areas and bypass the law, there are hundreds of diligent entrepreneurs who are toiling the government line and are only asking for fewer regulatory hurdles. We will do well to remember that the path to Viksit Bharat will be built as much by our large companies and rockstar startups as by the strong core of the Indian MSME sector.

Views expressed are personal

News at a glance

Top Saudi cleric urges troops to defend against Houthis

DUBAI: Saudi Arabia's top cleric has issued a rare statement, calling on the kingdom's troops to defend the country from the Iran-backed Houthi rebels in neighboring Yemen.

Israel's military, meanwhile, said two soldiers were killed in Gaza while inspecting an unexploded Israeli drone. In New York, the wars in Iran and Gaza have dominated the agenda at the UN General Assembly, where the leaders of Iraq, Lebanon and Egypt were scheduled to address the United Nations later Friday.

US trains Lankan officials on maritime sanctions evasion

COLOMBO: More than 40 Sri Lankan officials received training to strengthen the island nation's ability to detect and respond to maritime sanctions evasion, the US embassy said on Friday.

The three-day training focused on using tools to identify suspicious vessels and deceptive shipping practices, assess sanctions and proliferation risks, and strengthen interagency coordination when potentially illicit maritime activity is detected in or near Sri Lankan waters, the embassy said in a statement.

Fresh rains pose challenge to Nepal flood recovery

KATHMANDU: Heavy rainfall across large parts of Nepal has posed a fresh challenge to recovery efforts in areas devastated by the August 26 Bhotekoshi floods, with authorities warning of renewed risks of landslides, floods and debris flows.

Nepal's Department of Hydrology and Meteorology has forecast heavy to very heavy rainfall in several parts of the country from Friday through Sunday, with extremely heavy rain possible in parts of Gandaki and Lumbini provinces.



Women perform a cultural dance to mark the beginning of the week-long Indra Jatra festival, at Basantapur in Nepal

PTI

Pakistani forces kill several Afghan Taliban fighters

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Islamabad, September 25

Pakistani security forces killed several Afghan Taliban fighters after they allegedly attempted to enter Pakistan and opened hostilities along the border in Balochistan province, state-run media reported on Friday. The development comes after Pakistan conducted aerial and drone strikes on 10 locations in Afghanistan on Thursday.

Afghanistan's Taliban government said the strikes killed four civilians.

The state-run Associated Press of Pakistan (APP), citing security sources, said Afghan Taliban fighters attempted to enter Pakistani territory in Balochistan's Gulsitan sector on Thursday and carry out an "act of aggression".

Pakistani forces retaliated, killing several Afghan Taliban fighters, the report said, adding that intermittent exchanges of fire continued after midnight. Pakistan on Friday also rejected a claim by Afghanistan that its forces destroyed a Pakistani border post in the latest clashes.

CHINA PRESIDENT URGES GREATER COOPERATION ON AI

Trump hails Xi meet as 'very productive'

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Washington, September 25

US President Donald Trump on Friday described his meeting with Chinese President Xi Jinping as "very productive", saying the two sides discussed artificial intelligence (AI) and the future of cooperation between the United States and China.

Trump said Xi appeared to support his preference for calling AI "Super Intelligence". He made the remarks in a post on Truth Social after the leaders met at the White House on September 24.

Xi Jinping on Friday wrapped up his three-day visit to the US, asserting that his talks with President Donald Trump had added "new substance" to the China-US relationship and hoped for "more brighter prospects".

Trump and Xi continued their discussions over tea at the White House on Friday morning, where the US leader said China and the US had achieved "tremendous strides" during the visit that would make American farmers "very happy".



Xi said he looked forward to meeting Trump on two more occasions this year - at the APEC Summit in China and the G20 Summit in the US.

"I do welcome Mr President and the First Lady to visit China," Xi said in the meeting in the Red Room in the White House.

The US First Lady Melania Trump and China's first lady Peng Liyuan shared a sofa underneath a Hudson River School painting,

with Xi and Trump sitting in their own chairs. Tea and small plates of treats were on the coffee table between them.

"The president and I are like two people charting the course for the great ship of China-US relations. When the president visited China in May, we agreed on the vision of building a constructive China-US relationship of strategic stability," Xi said.

"This time, we've

agreed to add a new substance to it. The relationship will be a constructive one of strategic stability on the basis of respect, fairness, and reciprocity," the Chinese leader said in brief remarks to the media.

"So, from this one can see that the prospects for this relationship will get more brighter," Xi said.

Trump and Xi visited the National Archives, where the Declaration of Independence, the Con-

HIGHLIGHTS

- » Xi Jinping has wrapped up three-day visit to the US
- » Trump and Xi continued their discussions over tea at the White House
- » The US First Lady Melania Trump and China's first lady Peng Liyuan shared a sofa underneath a Hudson River School painting

stitution and the Bill of Rights are held. "We're just comparing. Ours goes 250 years. Which is great, and we're proud of.

Theirs goes 6,000 years. So there's a little difference between 6,000 and 250. But we're very proud of our 250," Trump said after he showed Xi the Declaration of Independence.

There has been no announcement of outcomes from the visit as yet. However, US Trade Representative Jamieson Greer said the US and China have reached agreements covering a subset of goods the two countries can trade on more favourable terms.

Iran offers US 7-day plan to reopen Hormuz

The proposal strongly resembles the so-called MoU reached in June



ASSOCIATED PRESS
Dubai, September 25

Iran has offered to reopen the Strait of Hormuz and resume talks on its nuclear programme in seven days if the United States lifts its naval blockade, waives sanctions on Iranian oil sales and observes a ceasefire that would include Lebanon.

Iran's Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi detailed the proposal in a private gathering on Thursday on the sidelines of the UN General Assembly in New York, according to one attendee.

Trita Parsi, executive vice president of the

Quincy Institute think tank, who attended, said Araghchi suggested that a speedy agreement would help US President Donald Trump ahead of November's mid-term elections.

There was no immediate comment from Iran's UN mission or other Iranian officials.

The proposal strongly resembles the so-called Memorandum of Understanding reached in June, but with an accelerated timetable.

The earlier agreement, which had called for a 60-day interim period, quickly collapsed as Iran resumed attacks on shipping in the strait.

Yemen's civil war returns, overwhelms hospitals with 'very dangerous situation'

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Aden, September 25

Tarek al-Salami, aged 7, sat in a diaper, looking frail. Normally, the malnutrition and diarrhoea that weakened his tiny frame would have been treated within a few days, but nothing is normal in Yemen anymore.

Tarek's father carried him on foot from

SOME HEALTH CENTRES ARE TURNING PREGNANT WOMEN & OTHERS IN NEED AWAY TO FOCUS ON TRAUMA PATIENTS

the southwestern city of Mokha as Iran-backed rebels swept in this month, bringing a return to civil

war. The boy reached a hospital two days later in the government-held city of Aden, 270 kilometres (170 miles) away, but it said it had no beds. Like others, it was overwhelmed by the wounded. They finally found a therapeutic feeding centre.

The boy arrived in "acute crisis" after the delay in care, according to the centre's director,

Dr Arwa Atef, and he only began walking again on Wednesday, over a week later. "I swear to God, when I look at him, my heart breaks," said his father, Mohammed al-Salami. "He looks almost lifeless." This is how the already fragile health system in the Arab world's poorest nation is collapsing, caught in a new front of the Iran war.

Pope Leo visits secular France



Pope Leo XIV

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Paris, September 25

Pope Leo XIV warned Friday that a "paradise of machines" risked undermining humanity as he opened a trip to France by posing fundamental questions about what it means to be human in the age of artificial intelligence, nuclear arms race and other threats to life itself.

Leo raised existential questions about scientific progress, life and human rights during his opening speech to President Emmanuel Macron and diplomats at the Elysee Palace.

Given the wars plaguing Europe and the Middle East, he reaffirmed the Vatican's opposition to nuclear weapons and said the nuclear deterrence doctrine was "mistaken" since it was just fueling a new arms race.

"Peace is not a balance of power; rather, it is built day by day through dialogue and justice," he said.

Leo arrived in Paris at the start of four intense days in France.

Imran Khan's party decides to postpone Sep 27 long march

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Islamabad, September 25

Pakistan's jailed former prime minister Imran Khan's party has decided to postpone its protest march towards Islamabad until October 4, party insiders said on Friday.

The Pakistan Tehreek-e-Insaf (PTI) party had announced the launch of a long march to the capital on September 27 to force the government to release party founder Khan but apparently decided to delay it due to the tough measures taken by the federal government to stop the protest.

Khan, 73, has been incarcerated since 2023, when he was arrested after conviction in a corruption case. He is lodged at the high-security Adiala Jail in Rawalpindi.

Party sources said the decision to postpone the protest was taken at a meeting and would be formally announced by Khyber Pakhtunkhwa Chief Minister Sohail Afridi.

"The protest will be launched on October 4 instead of September 27," the source said.

Earlier in the day, Afridi said at a press conference in Peshawar that the planned long march on Islamabad would go ahead despite road blockades and other measures.

"Our long march will definitely take place. This time, we will definitely come out," said Afridi.

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ग्रेटर नौएडा औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण
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वेबसाइट : www.greaternoidaauthority.in, ई-मेल : authority@gnida.in

पत्रांक-येनौ10/व090(तकनीकी)/2026/203

दिनांक- 25.09.2026

ई-निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना
वरिष्ठ प्रबंधक (ई-निविदा सेल) ग्रेटर नौएडा औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण द्वारा मुख्य कार्यपालक अधिकारी, ग्रेटर नौएडा की ओर से ई-निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना संख्या-येनौ10/व090(तकनीकी)/2026/202 दिनांक-25.09.2026 के माध्यम से उल्लेखित क्रम सं0 01 से 08 तक अंकित कार्य की ई-निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है। ई-निविदा की समस्त नियम व शर्तें ग्रेटर नौएडा प्राधिकरण की वेबसाइट: www.greaternoidaauthority.in पर ई-निविदा लिंक एवं ई-पोर्टल <https://etender.up.nic.in> पर उपलब्ध है। किसी परिवर्तन, संशोधन व अतिरिक्त सूचनाओं के लिए उक्त वेबसाइट देखते रहें।

क्र.सं.	कार्य का नाम/वर्क संक्षिप्त	अनुमानित लागत
1.	Supply of 06 CNG Based Truck Mounted Anti- Smog Guns under Package-A	रु. 3.60 करोड़
2.	Supply of 02 CNG Based Truck Mounted Anti- Smog Guns under Package-B	रु. 1.20 करोड़
3.	Supply of 04 CNG Based Truck Mounted Anti- Smog Guns under Package-C	रु. 2.40 करोड़
4.	Supply of 02 CNG Based Truck Mounted Anti- Smog Guns under Package-D	रु. 1.20 करोड़
5.	Supply of 04 CNG Based Truck Mounted Anti- Smog Guns under Package-E	रु. 2.40 करोड़
6.	Supply of 02 CNG Based Truck Mounted Anti- Smog Guns under Package-F	रु. 1.20 करोड़
7.	Supply of Battery operated of 05 Nos of Litter Picker Machine having 240 Ltr. Capacity.	रु. 55.28 लाख
8.	Selection of Project Management Unit to Support Gnida	To be Quoted by Bidder

क्रम सं0 02, 04, 06 व 07 की निविदाएँ दिनांक 28.09.2026 से 07.10.2026 को 17:00 बजे तक अपलोड किया जा सकता है, एवं प्राप्त ई-निविदाओं की प्री-क्वालिफिकेशन बिड दिनांक 09.10.2026 को 11:00 बजे खोली जायेगी एवं क्रम सं0 01, 03, 05 व 08 की निविदाएँ दिनांक 28.09.2026 से 12.10.2026 को 17:00 बजे तक अपलोड किया जा सकता है, एवं प्राप्त ई-निविदाओं की प्री-क्वालिफिकेशन बिड दिनांक 14.10.2026 को 11:00 बजे खोली जायेगी।

वरिष्ठ प्रबंधक (तकनीकी)

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Chhattisgarh State Industrial Development Corporation Limited
(A Government of Chhattisgarh Undertaking)
(ISO 9001: 2015 Certified)
1st Floor, Udyog Bhawan, Ring Road No.1, Telibandha, Raipur (C.G.) – 492006
CIN: U45203CT1981SG001853, PAN: AABCM6288N, GST Regn. No. 22AABCM6288NSZY
Phone: 0771-6621000, Fax: 0771-2585794
Website: www.csidc.in, Email address: csidc.cg@nic.in, csidc_raipur@yahoo.com

NOTICE INVITING TENDER
(Through e-Procurement Portal Only)
NIT No. 30/CSIDC/E.E./Division-1/2026-27/ 200171 Raipur, Dated 24/09/2026

Chhattisgarh State Industrial Development Corporation Ltd., Raipur (CSIDC), a Government of Chhattisgarh Undertaking constituted under the Companies Act, engaged in Industrial Infrastructure Development & Other Related Activities in the State invites online tender for the following work :-

S.No.	Name of Work	Registered Contractor in CGPWD or in appropriate class in other dep't.	Probable Amount of Contract (PAC) (INR Crore)	Last Date for Submission of tender
A	Infrastructure development works i/c roads, drainage, culverts, water supply system, street light & Buildings for Proposed New Industrial area at Village- Bangoan (B), Tehsil- Patthalgaon, District- Jashpur (C.G.)	*Class-A & Above	12.77	15/10/2026

The tender document containing detailed terms & conditions, scope of works and other details can be downloaded from the web portal (website) <https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in> from **24/09/2026** Time 17:01 and shall be submitted online only. Amendment in tender, if any, will only be uploaded on the website and shall not be published in any newspaper.

NOTE: The interested tenderers for online submission of tender may contact CG e-Proc Helpdesk. Operated by Mjunction Services Limited, they may reach Helpdesk using 18004199140 (therein press 2 for CG e-Proc) or you can email them at Helpdesk.eproc@cgswan.gov.in

samvad 49182/3

Executive Engineer
Division-1

News at a glance

Tata Motors weighs further price hikes on cost pressure

NEW DELHI: Tata Motors Passenger Vehicles Managing Director Shailesh Chandra on Friday said the company is considering further progressive price increases as rising commodity costs pressure margins.

Chandra said that the company continues to absorb a significant portion of higher commodity costs while stepping up cost-reduction efforts. He said any future increases would be incremental to minimise demand impact, with the company reviewing pricing every month. Tata Motors has already raised prices in September.

Suzuki targets producing 4 mn units in India from FY30

NEW DELHI: Suzuki Motor Corporation on Friday said it will strengthen production capacity in India, targeting annual output of around 4 million units from FY30, making the country a key manufacturing and export hub. The Japanese automaker, which owns around 58 per cent of Maruti Suzuki India, unveiled its "Technology Strategy 2026 for 10 Years Ahead".

It aims to improve development efficiency by 30 per cent and manufacturing efficiency by 50 per cent from FY20 levels by FY30. It will leverage digital engineering, modularisation & concurrent development to shorten vehicle development time.

Accel India, 360 ONE sell over 4% stake in BlueStone

NEW DELHI: Accel India and 360 ONE Group sold a little over 4 per cent stake in omnichannel jewellery retailer BlueStone for Rs 513 crore through separate block deals on the BSE.

The investors sold 61.98 lakh shares, or 4.07 per cent stake, at an average Rs 827.60 per share. Accel sold 28 lakh shares, while 360 ONE offloaded 33.98 lakh shares. Accel's holding declined to 8.71 per cent from 10.55 per cent. Domestic and foreign institutional investors bought the shares, including SBI Life Insurance, which acquired 9.5 lakh shares for Rs 79 crore, raising its stake to 5.02 per cent.

Dabur India gets NCLT approval for Sesa Care merger

NEW DELHI: Dabur India on Friday said it has received NCLT approval for the merger of ayurvedic hair care brand Sesa Care with the company.

Dabur said the merger will complement its existing hair care portfolio and create new growth opportunities. The company acquired a majority stake in Sesa Care in October 2024, while its board approved the merger scheme in May 2025. Dabur Global CEO Mohit Malhotra said the integration would leverage the company's distribution network, category expertise and international presence to expand Sesa Care's reach and unlock revenue and cost synergies.

AIMED AT BOOSTING TWO-WAY TRADE

‘India, Australia working on bilateral investment treaty’

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 25

India and Australia are working on a comprehensive economic cooperation agreement and a Bilateral Investment Treaty (BIT) to boost two-way trade and strengthen economic ties, Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal said on Friday.



THE TWO COUNTRIES HAVE IMPLEMENTED AN ECONOMIC COOPERATION AND TRADE AGREEMENT IN 2022 AND ARE NOW NEGOTIATING TO EXPAND ITS SCOPE INTO A COMPREHENSIVE ECONOMIC COOPERATION AGREEMENT (CECA)

Addressing ICAI's first Oceania International Conference 2026 in Australia, the minister said the two countries can enhance cooperation in areas like education, and critical minerals.

The two countries have implemented an Economic Cooperation and Trade Agreement (ECTA) in 2022 and are now negotiating to expand the scope of the pact into a Comprehensive Economic Cooperation Agreement (CECA).

"Now we have decided to work towards a very balanced, fair and equitable, comprehensive economic cooperation agreement, which will also take our relationship to greater heights. We are working with Australia to have a bilateral investment treaty also," he said. BITs provide protection to investments in other countries. They also help promote two-way investments.

"We are looking to have Australia and India as a trusted partnership. We both complement each other. Australia has critical minerals. We have manufacturing and processing ambitions. Australian universities and our young talent complement each other. Australia's patient capital and our appetite for growth complement each other," Goyal said.

"We have also sorted out the problem of cross-border taxation that several service providers, particularly the IT companies, were facing. We have also had greater engagement on respecting each other's due

diligence to try to reduce the compliance burden on businesses and citizens," the minister said.

He suggested the ICAI members move from being stewards of capital to architects of innovation and sustainable enterprises; and become ambassadors of India-Australia to open newer opportunities in renewable energy technologies, and supporting each other in critical minerals availability, and processing.

"Can we work together in the field of education, maybe providing dual degrees to our students from India and to the Australian students who we

KEY POINTS

- » We are working with Australia to have a bilateral investment treaty also, Goyal said
- » BITs provide protection to investments in other countries. They also help promote two-way investments
- » 'We both complement each other. Australia has critical minerals. We have manufacturing and processing ambitions,' Goyal said
- » 'Australia's patient capital and our appetite for growth complement each other,' the commerce and industry minister said

would like to invite to India to spend maybe six months or a year here," he added.

The minister suggested them to become a bridge between educational institutions of the two countries.

"...Be the reconciler of a fragmented world. I think institutes like the Chartered Accountants Institute, the CA ANZ and the CPA Australia can help working together through a deeper mutual recognition agreement so that we can have a seamless flow of Australian chartered accountants and CPAs coming to India as Indian chartered accountants serve Australian businesses," he added.

India has strongest growth outlook globally: World Economic Forum

ANI NEWS
New Delhi, September 25

India has emerged with the strongest growth outlook among economies covered in the World Economic Forum's September 2026 Chief Economists' Outlook, with 74 per cent of surveyed chief economists expecting strong or very strong growth over the next 12 months, up sharply from 52 per cent in May.

Overall, 98 per cent of respondents expect India to record moderate or stronger growth over the coming year, while the growth forecast for 2026-27 was raised to 6.7 per cent in August, the report said. It attributed the outlook to continued resilience in domestic demand, although higher energy prices remain a drag.

"Of chief economists surveyed, 98% expect moderate or stronger growth over the next 12 months, including 74% who anticipate strong or very strong growth, compared with 52% in May," the report noted.

The assessment places India ahead of other major economies in the survey. South-East Asia followed, with 73 per cent of respondents expecting strong or very strong growth, while 31 per cent of economists expect weak growth in China. Europe remained the weakest-performing region, with 61 per cent anticipating weak or very



OVERALL, 98% OF RESPONDENTS EXPECT INDIA TO RECORD MODERATE OR STRONGER GROWTH OVER THE COMING YEAR

weak growth.

The report also points to a more stable global economic outlook. Only 45 per cent of surveyed chief economists now expect global economic conditions to weaken over the next 12 months, sharply lower than 89 per cent in May.

A majority, 56 per cent, expect the outlook to remain unchanged or strengthen. Inflation expectations have also eased, with 50 per cent expecting global inflation to rise, compared with 94 per cent in May.

However, risks remain significant. Geopolitical conflicts were identified by 97 per cent of respondents as a major source of global economic uncertainty over the next year, followed by asset price corrections at 58 per cent. Only 25 per cent expect the global economy to become more resilient

HIGHLIGHTS

- » South-East Asia followed, with 73% of respondents expecting strong or very strong growth, 31% of economists expect weak growth in China
- » Europe remained the weakest-performing region, with 61 per cent anticipating weak or very weak growth
- » Report also points to a more stable global economic outlook. A majority, 56%, expect outlook to remain unchanged or strengthen

over the next 12 months.

Chief economists expect economic resilience to depend increasingly on economic diversification and flexible supply chains, cited by 78 per cent, followed by technological acceleration and innovation at 67 per cent and energy-market adaptation at 61 per cent.

Fiscal support, which was the leading source of resilience since 2020 at 69 per cent, falls to 28 per cent in the forward-looking assessment as governments face tighter fiscal constraints.

The report also described the global economy as having been "remarkably resilient" through successive shocks, while warning that future resilience will require greater adaptation as geopolitical, energy and technological pressures persist.

FDI rises 6% to \$19.81 billion in April-June, inflows from US fall 76%

AGENCIES
New Delhi, September 25

FDI in India rose 6 per cent to \$19.81 billion in April-June 2026-27 from \$18.62 billion in the same period of 2025-26, according to DPIIT data. However, inflows from the US fell over 76 per cent to \$1.34 billion from \$5.61 billion.

FDI almost doubled in April to 12.1 billion from \$6.6 billion in April 2025, but declined over 45 per cent year-on-year in May to 2.8 billion and 29 per cent in June to \$4.91 billion.

Japan was the largest investor at \$5.71 billion, followed by Singapore (\$5.22 billion), Mauritius (\$2.31 billion), the Netherlands (\$1.38 billion), the US (\$1.34 billion) and UAE (\$868 million).

FDI from the UAE fell to \$868 million from \$1 billion in April-June last fiscal.

Services attracted \$7.04 billion, followed by computer software and hardware (\$2.84 billion), trading (\$1.92 billion), non-conventional energy (\$1.24 billion) and auto (\$622 million). Total FDI, including equity inflows, reinvested earnings and other capital, increased about 22 per cent to \$30.65 billion.

Tamil Nadu received the highest inflow at \$5.95 billion, followed by Maharashtra (\$4.22 billion), Delhi (\$2.67 billion), Karnataka (\$2.11 billion) and Gujarat (\$1.3 billion).

NTPC pays final dividend of ₹3,393.83 cr for FY26

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 25

NTPC Ltd paid a final dividend of Rs 3,393.83 crore on September 23, 2026 for FY26, representing 35% of the Company's paid-up equity share capital.

This is in addition to the first and second interim dividends for FY26 of Rs 2,666.58 crore each, paid in November 2025 and February 2026, respectively.

With this, the total dividend paid for FY26 amounts to Rs 8,727 crore, equivalent to Rs 9.00 per

equity share of face value Rs 10 each. This is the 33rd Consecutive year that NTPC Ltd has paid dividend.

NTPC Ltd is India's largest integrated power utility with an installed capacity of over 91 GW, with another 35+ GW under construction. The company has set a target to reach 149 GW of total capacity by 2032, including 60 GW from renewable energy sources. This includes a balanced mix of thermal, hydro, solar, and wind power plants.

Tata Sons-Tata Trusts boardroom dispute deepens

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 25

Tata Sons, the holding company of the Tata Group, is facing a major boardroom dispute, with its biggest shareholder, Tata Trusts, opposing key decisions taken by the company's board, according to a Reuters report.

Tata Trusts, which owns a 66 per cent stake in Tata Sons, has opposed the reappointment of Chairman N Chandrasekaran and the board's decision to proceed with a possible stock market listing.

The Trusts, led by Noel



Tata, is represented by lawyer Abhishek Manu Singhvi, who has argued that the dispute concerns shareholder supremacy and that the board cannot operate independently of the controlling shareholder.

Chandrasekaran has engaged former solicitor general Harish Salve, who maintains that the board

acted in accordance with Tata Sons' internal governance rules.

At the centre of the dispute are the company's Articles of Association, which are not public. Tata Trusts argues that the chairman's reappointment required support from both its two nominees on the board.

Tata Sons maintains that the two nominees voted differently, triggering a casting vote that enabled Chandrasekaran's reappointment.

The Trusts' ability to call a Tata Sons shareholders' meeting is also currently

constrained. Sir Ratan Tata Trust, one of the key charities within the group, has been barred by a regulator from convening its own meetings amid a dispute over internal appointments.

The Trusts are considering approaching a court to lift the restriction or waiting for the regulatory inquiry to conclude, according to people familiar with the matter.

They are also weighing a challenge before the Mumbai company tribunal against Chandrasekaran's reappointment and may approach the Bombay High Court over the proposed Tata Sons listing.

CORPORATE KALEIDOSCOPE



A special seminar on 'Managing Stress & Ego – The Key to Happiness' was organised at Rail Coach Factory, Kapurthala, with the objective of promoting stress management, positive thinking & healthy work-life balance among officers & employees. The programme was inaugurated by the chief speaker, Rajyogini Usha Didi Senior Rajyoga Teacher, Brahm Kumaris, Mount Abu , General Manager, RCF Ajay Nandan & Navita Nandan, President, RCF Women Welfare Organisation, by lighting the ceremonial lamp.



J&K Bank has signed an MoU with Baba Ghulam Shah Badshah University (BGSBU), Rajouri to enhance banking convenience & facilitating efficient, technology-enabled financial services for the University's staff & students. The MoU was signed in presence of BGSBU Vice Chancellor Prof. Jawaid Iqbal, Registrar Ravi Kumar Sihag, Bank's DGM & Zonal Head (Rajouri) Rajeev Kumar Diga, AGM & Cluster Head (Rajouri) Ashish Jamwal, BGSBU CP & AO Qamar Rehman & BGSBU Branch Head Ashok Rotra.

Infra projects see cost overrun of ₹2.88 lakh crore in August
The report monitored 1,731 ongoing projects across 17 central ministries/departments

AGENCIES
New Delhi, September 25

Infrastructure projects worth more than Rs 150 crore each recorded a cumulative cost overrun of around Rs 2,88,122 crore, according to the government's August 2026 report.

The report monitored 1,731 ongoing projects across 17 central ministries/departments.

Their revised cost stood at Rs 33,60,069 crore against an original cost of Rs 30,71,947 crore. It did not specify the num-



ber of projects facing cost overruns.

Cumulative expenditure was Rs 16.33 lakh crore, or 48.59 per cent of

revised costs, Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI) said. As many as 647 projects (38 per cent) achieved

KEY POINTS

- » The Ministry of Road Transport & Highways had the highest number of projects at 982 (57 per cent), with revised costs of Rs 9.52 lakh crore (28 per cent)
- » Railways had 147 projects worth Rs 3.14 lakh crore, while Coal had 122 projects worth Rs 2.22 lakh crore

over 80 per cent physical progress, while 312 (18 per cent) crossed 80 per cent financial completion.

Transport & Logistics

accounted for 1,191 projects, with revised costs of Rs 16.05 lakh crore. The sector represented 48 per cent of total revised project costs and 69 per cent of projects.

The Ministry of Road Transport & Highways had the highest number of projects at 982 (57 per cent), with revised costs of Rs 9.52 lakh crore (28 per cent).

Railways had 147 projects worth Rs 3.14 lakh crore, while Coal had 122 projects worth Rs 2.22 lakh crore.

The energy sector comprised 223 projects with an aggregated revised cost of Rs 10.95 lakh crore (32 per cent). Water & Sanitation had 53 projects worth Rs 2.04 lakh crore (6 per cent), while Communication infrastructure covered 31 projects costing Rs 1.34 lakh crore (4 per cent).

Social & Commercial infrastructure comprised 81 projects with revised costs of Rs 0.97 lakh crore (3 per cent), while 'Others' covered 152 projects worth Rs 2.26 lakh crore (7 per cent).

 North central railways
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 www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

News at a glance

Chess: Indian men, women beat Germany, Uzbekistan

SAMARKAND: Reigning world champion D Gukesh led Indian men's team to a 2.5-1.5 victory over Germany while the women's team crushed Uzbekistan 3-1 in the ninth round of the 46th chess Olympiad here.

Gukesh struggled for the major part of the game but came back strongly to weave a checkmate web around the white king of Alexander Donchenkov, named, said. It was this turn of events that turned the tide in favour of Indian men who were staring at a defeat against Germany.

Impressive India draw 1-1 with World Cuppers Panama

BENGALURU: A spirited India surrendered their slender lead but still had plenty to feel good about as they held world No. 44 Panama to a 1-1 draw in a FIFA International friendly here on Friday.

The draw against a country that played the FIFA World Cup only a couple of months back and had a number of players from that tournament in its ranks will certainly be rated as the best under head coach Khalid Jamil. For India, Ryan Williams, Australian of Indian descent, struck in 41st minute but Omar Valencia equalised in the 68th minute.

Diya Chitale, Manush Shah settle for bronze after SF loss

NAGOYA: India's Manush Shah and Diya Chitale settled for a bronze medal in table tennis mixed doubles event after losing 0-4 to China's Wang Chuqin and Sun Yingsha in the semifinals of the Asian Games, here on Friday.

The Indian pair went down 8-11 5-11 8-11 2-11 in under 30 minutes at Sky Hall Toyota. Despite the semifinal defeat, Shah and Chitale secured India's first table tennis medal of the ongoing Games. Earlier in the day, Shah and Chitale stunned world No. 4 Doo Hoi Kem and Wong Chun Ting.

Khalin Joshi wins Bengaluru Open golf tournament

BENGALURU: Local favourite Khalin Joshi closed in with a two-under 70 to complete a wire-to-wire victory at Bengaluru Open golf tournament here on Friday.

The 34-year-old Bengaluru golfer (61-68-69-70), who began the final round with a three-shot advantage at his home course, made five birdies and three bogeys to finish at 20-under 268. His five-stroke victory secured his 10th DP World PGTI title and fourth of the season. Joshi collected Rs 15 lakh as prize money.

GULVEER AND MANPREET BAG SILVER AND BRONZE

Baranica wins India's maiden pole vault medal

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Nagoya, September 25

Baranica Elangovan on Friday scripted history by becoming the first Indian to win a pole vault medal at the Asian Games, clinching a bronze, while Gulveer Singh also entered into record books, becoming the first track and field athlete from the country to achieve podium finishes twice in 10,000m race with a silver here.

Shot putter Manpreet Kaur then redeemed herself after years of toil, winning a bronze, as India bagged three medals on the third day of athletics competition.

India's medals tally in athletics has swelled to five, with the two of them coming on Thursday.

Baranica shared the bronze with Ivanova Polina of Kazakhstan after both soared over 4.15m and there was nothing to separate the two in the count-back in a rare joint award of a medal in a major tournament.

Both cleared 3.65m, 3.85m and 4m in their respective first attempts.



India's Baranica Elangovan competes in the women's pole vault event during the 20th Asian Games, in Nagoya on Friday

Then, both of them needed second attempts to clear 4.15m but failed to rise above 4.25m in three attempts.

"This is incredible. I'm really happy that I could able to bring a medal for my country. It's my dream actually to write history and I did it today," the 29-year-old from Tamil Nadu said.

"I never thought of giving up because my coach made me mentally prepared for everything," said Baranica about her coach Milber Bertrand Russel who was also present here. She said she did not believe it when Sindhushree G, the other Indian in the fray, told her that I had won a bronze.

"I didn't know actu-

ally, I was checking. Sindhushree was telling me that I have won a bronze. I didn't believe, I said I need to check, re-check. I checked it twice, thrice and then only I got to know about the medal."

"I didn't believe it actually, I was telling my coach, this was the medal, there was a display and I



Gulveer Singh poses with his country's flag after competing in the men's 10,000-meter final at the Asian Games

was asking him to check, how come I didn't know like that. I was really excited after seeing that, but also not believing."

Meanwhile, Gulveer clinched a silver to become the first Indian to win to medals in 10,000m in the Asian Games history.

The 28-year-old Gulveer, who had won a

bronze in the same event in the last edition China, clocked 28 minute 29.38 seconds to take the second spot behind defending champion Birhanu Balew of Bahrain, who claimed the gold in 28 minutes 27.51 seconds.

Albert Kipto, also from Bahrain, completed the podium with a time of 28:34.18.

Tennis: Tough Asiad singles draw for India; doubles best bet

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Nagoya, September 25

India have been handed a challenging draw in the Asian Games men's singles tennis competition, with seventh seed Sumit Nagal facing a particularly demanding route to the medal rounds, while 11th seed Dhakshineswar Suresh too has a tricky path in his half featuring top seed Coleman Wong.

Nagal seeded seventh, has received a first-round bye and will open his campaign against South Korea's Hong Seongchan, who is now ranked way below the Indian but is a tough nut to crack.

Both Nagal and Hong were part of the recent India-Korea Davis Cup tie. Hong is returning to the competitive tennis after serving in Korean Army and is a very formidable rival. A win would put the Indian in the third round against either Tajikistan's Somon Amonov or ninth seed Sergey Fomin of Uzbekistan.

The road gets considerably tougher thereafter, with third seed Wu Yib-

KEY POINTS

- » Nagal seeded seventh, has received a first-round bye
- » Dhakshineswar Suresh has a similarly difficult route to last-four
- » India have no representation in the women's singles main draw

ing and eighth seed Hayato Matsuoaka of Japan among the seeded players in Nagal's quarter of the draw. Wu, ranked 113, is the highest-ranked player in that section.

For Nagal, for a likely presence in the potential medal round, he will need to get past Hong Seongchan in the second round, Amonov or Fomin in the third, followed by a potential quarterfinal against Wu or Matsuoaka.

Nagal will need to reach the semifinals to assure himself of a medal, making the route especially demanding given the quality of players placed in his section.

Gill cops blow on elbow, Kohli Rohit return to nets

Gill needed an extended period for medical attention

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Thiruvananthapuram, September 25

Indian skipper Shubman Gill on Friday suffered an injury scare when pacer Mohammad Siraj's rising delivery pinged on his elbow during nets.

Gill, who appeared to be in considerable pain, needed an extended period of nearly 20 minutes of medical attention. The right-hander even-



No training for West Indies

The West Indies touched down in the city on September 23. But they are yet to hit the ground for training.

It may be noted that the West Indies cricket has plunged to another round of chaos after the nation's governing body has announced a 25 per cent reduction in retainer fees as part of a wide-ranging series of steps being undertaken as part of financial rejig.

While the international players will retain their 12-month contracts, domestic players will be on retainer contracts cut to seven months.

"And we're quite fortunate that we've got a lot of experience and conversations, and that can only be great for the team. So, yeah, we're quite fortunate that we've got that experience with the senior players."

"For us, it's just to keep on challenging the guys to have the conversation with the senior guys. We always throw up as many questions as possible in team meetings for the senior guys to speak and to share their experience.

HIMACHAL PRADESH GOVT. RURAL DEVELOPMENT DEPARTMENT NOTICE INVITING E-TENDER

On line-item rate bids are hereby invited by the Executive Engineer (RDD) Zonal Office Dharamshala, Distt. Kangra H.P. on behalf of Governor of Himachal Pradesh from the contractors/ firms of appropriate class registered with HPPWD for the following work(s) through E- Tendering mode:-

Sr. No.	Name of Work	Estimated Cost. (in Rs)	Earnest Money (in Rs.)	Cost of tender form (in Rs.)	Time Limit	Contractor Class
1	Construction of Temple Peer Gouns Pak Giyar-windfalls, at Changer (Makrer), Dev. Block Bangono, Distt. Una H.P. (S&L-Balance work for the completion of basement -I & basement -II)	35718493.00	714400.00	7000.00 (Non-refund-able)	18 Months	B

1. The Starting Date for Submission / Downloading of E-Tender Documents on the HP E Tender Portal is 03-10-2026 from 05:00 PM onwards and Last date for Submission/uploading the tender on the Portal is 13-10-2026 upto 05:00 PM.
2. Tender document and other instructions/conditions can be downloaded or viewed on line from the portal <https://hptenders.gov.in> by the firm/individual

Executive Engineer (RDD)
Zonal Office Dharamshala
Distt. Kangra H.P.-176215

Ro.No 3668/2026-2027

NORTHERN RAILWAY TENDER NOTICE (Through e-tendering)

Name of work with its location	Provision of Railnet at balanced Railway stations/Depots/ Offices inside Delhi area of Delhi Division.
App. Cost of the work (₹)	₹ 3,04,50,151.95/- only
Earnest Money Deposit (₹)	₹ 6,09,000/- only
Address of the office	Senior Divisional Signal & Telecom Engineer-C, Northern Railway, 3 rd Floor, Annexe-1, DRM Office, New Delhi-110055.
Date & Time for upload the tender/closing of tender	Tender uploading / closing date & time 16.10.2026 upto 15:00 hrs.
Website particular & notice board location where complete details of the tender can be seen etc.	See the Northern Railway website www.ireps.gov.in & Notice board at S&T branch, 3 rd Floor, DRM office, State Entry Road, New Delhi-110055.
Tender No.: 558-Sig-16-Tele-OT-1048	Dated: 24.09.2026 3329/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

S. E. RAILWAY – TENDER

For & On behalf of The President of India, Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer (TRD), Chakradharpur, invites e-Tender as mentioned below. Tenders are due to open on 16.10.2026 at 15:30 hrs. The Manual offers are not allowed against this tender and any such manual offer received shall be ignored. **SL No.: 1: Name of the work:** OHE/PSI maintenance of Rourkela Steel Plant (RSP) Siding at Rourkela in CKP Division for one year. **Tender Notice No: CKP-D-602-RSP-SDG-2026. Tender Value Rs: ₹ 48,75,486.11/-; EMD: ₹ 97,500.00/-; SL No.: 02: Name of the work:** OHE modification works in Banspani iron Ltd. (BIL) private siding at JRLI of CKP Division. **Tender Notice No: CKP-D-707-BIL-SDG-JRLI; Tender Value Rs: ₹ 12,55,460.64/-; EMD: ₹ 25,100.00/-; SL No.: 03: Name of the work:** Replacement of composite insulators by porcelain insulators over CKP Division. (Phase-II). **Tender Notice No: CKP-D-626-COMP-2026; Tender Value Rs: ₹ 5,41,68,344.86/-; EMD: ₹ 10,83,200.00/-; SL No.: 04: Name of the work:** OHE Modification work in connection with the development of siding infrastructure for Track Machine at 9 Station in CKP Division. **Tender Notice No: CKP-D-640-Track-MC-SDG; Tender value Rs: ₹ 2,02,06,572.65/-; EMD: ₹ 4,04,100.00/-; SL No.: 05: Name of the Work:** Provision of Auxiliary transformers in connection with construction of 02 Nos. goomties related to construction of additional 03 lines at DPS yard in CKP Division. **Tender Notice No: CKP-D-641-DPS-AT-2026; Tender Value Rs: ₹ 8,96,398.44/-; EMD: ₹ 17,900.00/-; Date & Time of Opening of Tender :** 16.10.2026 At 15:30 hrs. for SL No. 1 to 5 each; **Completion Period:** 06 Months for SL No. 2 & 5 each; 12 Months for SL No. 1 & 4 each and 18 Months for SL No. 3. **Place of opening of e-tender:-** Sr. DEE/TRD/ South Eastern Railway. **Date and Time of Closing of Tender:-** 15:00 hrs. of 16.10.2026. **Date and Time of Opening Tender:** 15:30 hrs. of 16.10.2026 e-tender can be viewed at Website <http://www.ireps.gov.in> The tenderer/ bidders must have Class-III Digital Signature Certificate & must be registered on IREPS Portal. Only registered tenderer/bidders can participate on E-Tendering. All relevant paper must be uploaded at the time of participating in E-tendering. (PR-807)

C.G. Police Housing Corporation, Raipur
Head Office - P.H.Q. Campus, North Block, Sector-19, Nava Raipur, Atal Nagar (C.G.) Phone 0771 - 2331800
Tender No. / 1023 to 1045 /CGPHC/Bldg/2026 Dated 25/09/2026

TENDER NOTICE (1st, 2nd and 3rd Call)

Online Tenders are invited according to key dates for Construction of Auditorium Building at Police Public Senoor Raipur, Distt. - Raipur, 48 H.C./Cons. Quarters (G+2) at Balodabazar (District Police), 48 H.C./Cons. Quarters (G+2) at Kabirdham (District Police), 12 H.C./Cons. Flats (G+2) at Balod (District Police), 24 H.C./Cons. Flats (G+2) at S.P. Rail Raipur, Maintenance Work of 16 + 32 Quarters Block - H1, H2 (Part 01 & Part 02) & G Block - (Part 01 & Part 02) at Dhanora Camp, Dalli Rajhara, Police Chowki Building at Dindo, Superintendent of Police Office at Surguja Dist. - Surguja, Jashpur Dist. - Jashpur, Balodabazar - Bhatapara Dist. - Balodabazar Bhatapara, Kabirdham Dist. - Kabirdham, Proposed Sub Inspector Trainees Hostel at PTS Mana Raipur Dist. - Raipur, GO's Mess at Dantewada, Multi Storey Barrack at Raipur, Durg & Kondagaon, GO's Transit Hostel at Durg, Mungeli, Kondagaon, Rajnandgaon, Mohla - Manpur - Ambagarh Chowki, NGO Transit Hostel at Mungeli & Jashpur, Constable / Head Constable Transit Hostel at Dhamtari, Mohla - Manpur - Ambagarh Chowki, Jashpur & Dantewada, Head Constable / Constable Houses (G+1) (08 Nos.) & (G+2) (36 Nos.) & N.G.O. Houses (G+2) (12 Nos.) at Sukma (District Police), Head Constable / Constable Houses (G+2) (48 Nos.) at 12th Bn. Ramanujganj & Head Constable / Constable Houses (G+2) (24 Nos.) & N.G.O. Houses (P+6) (24 Nos.) at Jagdalpur (District Police), N.G.O. Houses (G+2) (12 Nos.) at Sukma (District Police), Head Constable / Constable Houses (G+2) (36 Nos.) at Gaurela Pendra Marwahi (District Police), N.G.O. Houses (G+2) (12 Nos.) at Bilaspur (District Police), 156 H.C./Constable Flats (G+2) at Sukma (District Police), 12 N.G.O. (G+2) & 48 H.C./Constable Flats (G+2) at Dhamtari (District Police), 60 Hc/C Flats (G+2) & 12 Ngo Flats (G+2) At Balrampur (Distt. Police), 60 Hc/C Flats (G+2), at Raigarh (Distt Police), 96 Hc/C Flats (G+2) & 24 Ngo Flats (G+2) At Mohla-Manpur-Ambagarh Chowki (District Police), 24 Hc/C Flats (G+2) & 12 Ngo Flats (G+2), & 24 Ngo Flats (P+6) At Jashpur (Distt. Police), 24 Hc/C Flats (G+2), 48 Hc/C Flats (P+6) & 12 Ngo Flats (G+2) At 6th Bn Raigarh, 16 Hc/C Flats (G+1), 132 Hc/C Flats (G+2) & 12 Ngo Flats (G+2) At Bijapur (Distt. Police), 96 Hc/C Flats (G+2), at Kondagaon (Distt. Police), H.C./Constable Flats (G+2) 60 Nos & NGO House G+2 (12 Nos) at 9th Bn. Karli Dantewada, H.C./Constable Flats (G+2) 72 Nos & NGO House G+2 (24 Nos) at Dantewada (District Police), H.C./Constable Flats (G+2) 96 Nos at 15th Bn. Bijapur, Female Police Station at Dantewada, Jagdalpur (Bastar), Raigarh & Jashpur, CSP Office Building at Nava Raipur, DSP Office Building for AJK DSP Kanker at Kanker, DSP Office Building at Dantewada, CSP Office Building at Rajnandgaon, M.T. Office / Workshop at 2nd Bn. Sakri, 3rd Bn. Amleshwar Dist. -Durg, 16th Bn. Narayanpur & 17th Bn. Kabirdham, Investigation Officer Residential Barrack at PS Sanna Dist.-Jashpur, PS Fingeshwar Dist.- Gariyaband, PS Kansabel Dist.-Jashpur, PS Gurur Dist.-Balod, PS Daundi Dist.- Balod, PS Khamariya Dist.-Bemetara, PS Kota Dist.-Bilaspur, PS Pachpedi Dist.-Bilaspur, PS Tirukunda Dist.-Balrampur, PS Lalpur Dist.-Mungeli, PS Pandatarai Dist.-Kabirdham, PS Bodla Dist.-Kabirdham, PS Udaypur Dist.-Surguja, PS Lemru Dist.-Korba, PS Raghunathnagar Dist.-Balrampur, PS Ramanujnagar Dist.-Surajpur, PS Pusaur Dist.-Raigarh, PS Berla Dist.-Bemetara, PS Manpur Dist.-M-M-A.C, PS Tilda-Neora Dist.-Raipur, PS Gobra-Nawapara Dist.-Raipur, PS Singhoda Dist.-Mahasamund, PS Borai Dist.-Dhamtari, PS Chura Dist.-Gariyaband, PS Bortalab Dist.-Rajnandgaon, PS Baghbahar Dist.-Jashpur, PS Pakhanjur Dist.-Kanker, PS Mainpur Dist.-Gariyaband, PS Bori Dist.-Durg, PS Ramkola Dist.-Surajpur, PS Anda Dist.-Durg, PS Dondi-Lohara Dist.-Balod, PS Nagri Dist.-Dhamtari, Female Police Station at Raipur & Rajnandgaon, CSP Office at Manendragarh Bharatpur Chirmiri, DSP Office at Mohla Manpur Ambagarh Chowki, M.T. Office /Workshop at 13th Bn. Korba, Investigation Officer Residential Barrack at PS Chal Dist.-Raigarh & Gidhauri Dist.-Balodabazar-Bhatapara, Transit Hostel Building at Mahasamund, S.D.O.P. office at Jagargunda, Maraiguda & Sukma Dist.-Sukma, Additional Superintendent of Police office at Konta, Additional Superintendent of Police office Yatayat at Nava Raipur, 12 H.C./Cons. Flats (G+2) at PTS Mainpat, GO's House (E - Type) Additional S.P & S.D.O.P Kondagaon Quarter at Kondagaon, GO's House (E - Type) S.P & Additional S.P & D.S.P Head Quarter at Narayanpur, Construction Of 48 Hc/C Flats (G+2) & 24 Ngo Flats (G+2) At 10th Bn. Surajpur, 60 Hc/C Flats (G+2) & 12 Ngo Flats (G+2) At Janjgir - Champa (Distt. Police), 48 Hc/C Flats (G+2) & 12 Ngo Flats (G+2) At Sakli (Distt. Police), Investigation Officer Residential Barrack at PS Saliba Dist.-Sarangarh-Bilaigarh, 84 Head Constable / Constable Flats (G+2) at Manendragarh - Bharatpur- Chirmiri (District Police), Head Constable / Constable Houses (G+2) (48 Nos.) at 5th Bn. Jagdalpur & Hi Tech Police Station Building at Ramnagar Dist. Raipur online tender invitation Tender System No. - 197393, 197502, 197504 to 197506, 197508 to 197512, 197881, 197513 to 197515, 197517 to 197519, 197617, 197520, 197522, 197619, 197524 to 197529, 197531 to 197535, 197548, 197542, 197547, 197541, 197543 to 197545, 197870, 197546, 197547, 197871, 197549, 197550, 197552, 197553, 197873, 197554 to 197563, 197575 to 197584, 197586, 197587, 197589 to 197603, 197605 to 197608, 197610 to 197615, 198116 to 198118, 197882, 197896, 197898 to 197901, 198543, 198547, 198546, 198551, 198554, 198555, 199022, 199043, 199045 & 199575 Which are available from 01/10/2026 (10:30 am) to 12.10.2026 & 15.10.2026 & 21.10.2026 (17:30pm) in CGPHC Portal <https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in> along with other details.

samvad 47126/5

Managing Director

North Eastern Railway CORRIGENDUM

Auction/Corrigendum Notice No. 16/2026-27 Additional date of e-Auction published in September-2026 : Following additional e-auction date is added in published e-auction dates of September-2026 **Additional e-Auction dates:** 28 September-2026 **Jurisdiction of lots:** Sr.DMM/BSB. Other e-Auction dates and terms and conditions, as published vide Auction Notice No. 13/2026-27, will remain unchanged. This notice is also available on NE Railway website on www.ner.indianrailways.gov.in

Principal Chief Material Manager, CP/RS-65

DO NOT SMOKE BIDI/CIGARETTE IN TRAINS

millenniumpost CLASSIFIEDS CHANGE OF NAME

I, SHAHEEN W/O YOUSUF KHAN R/O 1695 GALI SAYYADAN PAHARI BHOJLA TURKMAN GATE DELHI-110006. That I have changed my name from SHAHIN PARVEEN to SHAHEEN for all purposes. That SHAHIN PARVEEN and SHAHEEN are one and the same person i.e. myself. That in future I shall be known and called by the name SHAHEEN.

**EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY**
E-TENDER NOTICE

e-tender Notice No. 46 of 2026-27 (Open)-Engg/DDU. On line (through e-tendering) for the following work is invited by DRM/Engg/DDU for and on behalf of the President of India from experienced and financially as well as technically sound contractors including those enlisted with the Railway, CPWD, BSNL, MES, PWD and other public sector undertakings :-

1. Tender No. 13-DDU-SR DEN-III-26-27. Name of work with its location : Construction of 01 unit type IV quarter at JPL under ADEN/JPL. 2. Advertised Value : ₹9889079.41, 3. Earnest Money : ₹197800.00, 4. Closing Date & time for submission of e-tender : 19.10.2026, Up-to 12:00 hrs, 5. Website particulars of e-tendering : www.ireps.gov.in

Divisional Railway Manager/
ECR/PT, Deen Dayal Upadhyaya
PR/1010/DDU/Engg.T/26-27/28

PUBLIC NOTICE

This is to inform public in general that Kotak Mahindra bank Ltd has organized an auction in below mention respect of Vehicles. **VEHICLES FOR SALE**

1) MAH MAXTRUCK
REG. NO. DL1LAM1797-YOM-2024

2) MAH MM. BOLERO
REG. NO. DL1LAD7614-YOM -2020

UNDER HYPOTHECATION WITH M/S KOTAK MAHINDRA BANK IS UNDER SALE IN ITS "AS IS WHERE IS CONDITION" INTERESTED PARTIES CAN GIVE THEIR QUOTATIONS WITH IN 7 DAYS AT
BRANCH ADDRESS:
KOTAK MAHINDRA BANK
3RD FLOOR, PLOT NO 7,
SECTOR 125, NOIDA-201313
OR CONTACT : PUNIT PARASHAR
KOTAK MAHINDRA BANK LTD.
CONTACT NO. : 8377905498
EMAIL:-punit.parashar@kotak.com

**Govt. of Jharkhand**
OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER
Field Survey Division, Advance Planning, Road Construction
Department, Nirupan Bhawan, 4th floor, 56-Set Chowk, Doranda, Ranchi-834002
e-mail--- ceercdapsfdran-jhr@nic.in
e-Procurement (very Short Tender Notice)
Letter of Invitation (LOI) No.-14/2026-27
National Competitive Bidding (Two Bid System)
2nd Call
e-Tender Ref No-- RCD/FSD /AP/ RAN/14/26-27 Dated **24.09.2026**

1	Name Of Work	Consultancy services for preparation of Detailed project report for construction of road from Simdega Albert ekka Stadium to Sikriyatand to Sogra to Pakartand to Turtoli Via Kobang to Khanajoya to Bhadotoli to Purnapani to Binpur Raidih Border Road including proposal for R/ replacement of culverts and bridges, /ROR/RUB If any required, complete Land Acquisition P/ proposal including ownership details /all complete as per latest guidelines, Resettlement and Rehabilitation Plan and Forest Diversion Proposal including clearance of all stages etc as required, at Ranchi in the state of Jharkhand
2	Tentative Length	50.00 km
3	Period of Completion of Work	90 Days
4	Cost of Tender Document & Earnest Money Deposit (EMD)	Cost of Tender Document - Rs 5,000/- (Rupees Five Thousand)(Non-Refundable) through online mode only. EMD :- Rs. 50,000/- (Rupees Fifty thousand) through online mode only. As per the Departmental Letter no.-4652(S) dated 06.10.2023, cost of tender document and Earnest Money Deposit will be received in online mode only through e-procurement portal (https://jharkhandtenders.gov.in) by Internet banking/ NEFT/ RTGS facility as per Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) issued by Information Technology & e-Governance Department, Government of Jharkhand vide letter no- 120 dated 03.10.2023.
5	Mode of Bid Submission	e-tendering(http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in)
6	Date/Time of Publication of Tender on Website	28.09.2026, 17:00 PM
7	Last date and Time of submission of Tender (With Tender Fee and EMD)	16.10.2026, not later than 16:00 hrs
8	Date of opening of Bid	07.10.2026 at 16:30 hrs
9	Place of Opening	Chief Engineer (Comm), Road Construction Department, Engineer Hostel No -2, Dhurwa, Ranchi-834004
10	Designation and Contact no. of e-Procurement Officer	Executive Engineer, Field Survey Division, Advance Planning, RCD, Ranchi. Mobile No - 8051090751
11	PR No	389028 Road (26-27)D

Note:-Only e-Tender shall be accepted.
PR 390450 Road(26-27)D

Executive Engineer,
Field Survey Division,A.P
Road Construction Department,Ranchi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C. / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Pawan, S/o Bansai Lal, R/o AG-518, Shalimar Bagh, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 22/17, U/s 279/338 IPC, P.S. Rani Bagh, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Pawan** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Pawan** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Pawan** accused of **FIR No. 22/17, U/s 279/338 IPC, P.S. Rani Bagh, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **06.11.2026**.

By Order - Ms. Anuradha Jindal
Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate, North-West
DP/13575/OD/2026 Room No. 101, Rohini Courts, Delhi

**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**

Tender Notice No: GEM/2026/B/8072932 Date : 23.09.2026

E-TENDER NOTICE

Divisional Railway Manager (Engineering)/North Central Railway/Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invites the following E-Tenders on prescribed form for the following works up to **15.10.2026**. The details of the tenders are as under:

Gem Bid Number : GEM/2026/B/8072932 dated : 23.09.2026

Name of work: Rendering annual service of maintenance of section between SB (Incl.) to AAP (Incl.)-ML and ETW (Incl.) to Karhal (Incl.)-BL, other service buildings & Railway colonies in the section of SSE/W/ETW under ADEN/NCR/ETW for 02 years and Rendering annual service of maintenance of section between TDL (Excl.) to JGR (Incl.)-ML and SKB (Excl.) to FBD (Incl.)-BL, other service buildings & Railway colonies in the section of SSE/W/FZD under ADEN/NCR/FZD for 02 years.

Approx Cost (Rs.): 12112076.40	Earnest money (Rs.): 210560.00
DOC : 24 months	Date of closing : 15.10.2026

Eligibility Criteria for Similar work : Any Civil Engineering work

Note :- 1. Tender on line can be submitted up to the due date of tender closing. 2. The complete information along with tender document of above E-Tenders are available on Website www.gem.gov.in up to the due date of tender closing. 217026 (PH)

 North central railways  @CPRONCR  www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

**UJVN LIMITED**

H.O.: "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephones: 0135-2763808, Fax: 0135-2763508
CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866 Website: www.ujvn.com

Letter No: 862 Date: 25/09/2026

E-Tender Corrigendum (Time Extension Notice)

Due to unavoidable reason, the dates of following mentioned E-bid, invited by the office of the Executive Engineer, (M&G) Pathri Power House, Bahadradab, Haridwar are hereby extended:-

1. **Tender No.: 07/EE(Pathri)/2026-27** – Hiring of one no. Non-AC diesel driven vehicle (along with driver's services) for DGM, HGC, Pathri for a period of one year.

Last date of submission of bid on e-portal: 01.10.2026, at 16:00 Hrs.
Last date for submission of bid in hard copy: 03.10.2026, up to 16:00 Hrs.
Opening of bid on e-portal: 05.10.2026 at 11:00 Hrs.

All other terms and conditions of tender shall remain unchanged. For fuller & further details, kindly visit e-procurement portal "<https://uktenders.gov.in>"

EXECUTIVE ENGINEER (M&G)

"AVOID WASTEFUL USE OF ELECTRICITY"

NORTHERN RAILWAY

Invitation of Tenders through E-Procurement system

Principal Chief Materials Manager, Northern Railway, New Delhi-110001, for and on behalf of the President of India, invites e-tenders through e-procurement system for supply of the following items:-

S. Tender NO No.	Brief Description	Qty.	Closing Date
01	03263126 OVERHEAD DOUBLE ACTING CONCEALED DOOR CLOSER	8129 NOS	14-10-26
02	12260031D EARTHING CABLE FOR WHEEL SET	6364 NOS	19-10-26
03	09262017 CONSTANT CONTACT SIDE BEARER	3511 NOS	19-10-26
04	14260924 SILICON RUBBER COMPOUND	17380 NOS	21-10-26
05	07265097 SS UNDERSLING WATER TANK	6 NOS	24-10-26
06	09262114 LOCK	30646 NOS	26-10-26
07	06265036A RHS 40 X 80 X 4.00 MM CONFORMING	120000 KGS	27-10-26
08	07265073 SUPPLY AND FITMENT OF UPHOLSTERY	1024 NOS	27-10-26
09	77269054 RUNNING CONTRACT FOR PROCUREMENT OF PRESTRESSED CONCRETE SLEEPERS	200 SET	10-11-26

NOTE -1. Vendors may visit the IREPS website i.e. www.ireps.gov.in for details. 2. No Manual offer will be entertained.
Tender Notice NO. 45/2026-2027 Dated : 25.09.2026 3353/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person **Jagroop, S/o: Sh. Baljeet Singh R/o: Village Ghoghdiyan, Post Ghoghdiyan Ghoghriyan, PS & Teh. Uchana Kalan, Distt Jind, Haryana** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 310/19, Dt. 07.07.2019, U/s: 279/338/304A IPC PS: Jahangirpuri Delhi**, and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Jagroop**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Jagroop**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person **Jagroop**, of **FIR No. 310/19, Dt. 07.07.2019, U/s: 279/338/304A IPC PS: Jahangirpuri Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **29.10.2026**.

By Order
Sahil Gupta
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07
North Court No.6 Gourd Floor
Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/13504/NW/2026
(Court Matter)

**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**

E-Tender No. PRYJ-Sig-043-2026-27 Date:- 23.09.2026

E-TENDER NOTICE

Senior Divisional Signal & Telecommunication Engineer/ Coordination/ North Central Railway/Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invite E-TENDER on prescribed form for the following works up to **12.00 hrs. on 21.10.2026**. The details of the Tender is as under:-

Tender No.:- PRYJ-Sig-043-2026-27

Name of Work:- Provision of CCTV cameras at Goods shed at Aligarh, Hathras Fort, Chunar, Shakteshgarh and Shankargarh stations.

Approx. Cost of work (₹):- 1,73,06,901/-	Bid Security (₹):- 3,46,100/-
Cost of Tender Form (₹):- 0/-	Completion Period:- 12 months

Date of Closing of tender:- 21.10.2026

Availability of tender form:- Tender forms are available on www.ireps.gov.in 21 days prior to date of opening of the tender.

Earnest Money to be deposited:- The prescribed amount of Bid Security as mentioned above must be deposited along with the tender form Online through Internet Banking or Online Payment gateway.

The tender(s) should note that, in any case, the Bid Security in any other form specified in GCC shall be acceptable.

If the Bid Security deposited by the bidder is in shape of Bank Guarantee, it should be supported by proper stamp duty, rate prescribed as per section 13 & 24 of the UP Stamp Act, 2008 and amended from time to time at the time of submission of Bank Guarantee. Tenders without Bid Security shall be summarily rejected.

Time date & place of opening of tender:- Tender will be opened through E-tender at office of Divisional Railway Manager, Prayagraj on or after pre-determined date at 12.30 hours. In case tender opening of date happens to be holiday, Tenders will be opened on the next working day.

Validity of offer:- 60 days from the date of opening

Right of Railway to deal with tender:- Railway administration reserves the rights to postpone/modify or to cancel the tender without assigning any reasons.

Definition of similar work:- Any work involving supply, installation, testing and commissioning of Integrated Security System/ Video surveillance system/ Access Control, Personal & Baggage Screening system, Explosive Detection & Disposal System and their integration. 217726(D)

 North central railways  @CPRONCR  www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

**छत्तीसगढ़ स्टेट इण्डस्ट्रियल डेव्हलपमेंट कॉर्पोरेशन लिमिटेड**
(छत्तीसगढ़ सांसन का चयकम)
(ISO 9001:2015 Certified)
प्रधान कार्यालय, रायपुर रोड क्र.-1, तेलीबाघा रायपुर 492006 (छत्तीसगढ़)
CIN : U45203CT1981SG001853, PAN : AABCM6288N, GST No. 22AABCM6288NSZY
दूरभाष : कार्यालय- 0771-6621000 फैक्स- 0771-2583794
Website : www.csidc.in, Email address: csidc.cg@nic.in, csidc_raipur@yahoo.com

NOTICE INVITING TENDER [I Call]
(Through e-Procurement Portal Only)

NIT No. 12/CSIDC/E/State-III/2026-27 Raipur, Dated 24/09/2026

Chhattisgarh State Industrial Development Corporation Ltd., Raipur (CSIDC), a Government of Chhattisgarh Undertaking constituted under the Companies Act, engaged in Industrial Infrastructure Development & Other Related Activities in the State invites online tender from registered in Central/Semi Central/State Govt./PSU/ Local bodies of the state of Chhattisgarh for Type of Contract "Lump-Sump" for the following work :-

Name of work	Registered Contractor in CGPWB or in appropriate class in other dep't	Probable Amount of Contract (PAC) (INR Crore)	Last Date for Submission of Tender
Selection of Agency for Design, Engineering, Supply, Construction, Installation, Testing, Commissioning and Comprehensive Operation & Maintenance of Five (05) Years for proposed Effluent Treatment Plant (ETP) on Turnkey Basis at Pharmaceutical Park (Phase-I) Sector-22, Nava Raipur, Atal Nagar (C.G.).	Class-A	8.47 [Excluding GST]	15/10/2026

The tender document containing detailed terms & conditions, scope of works and other details can be downloaded from the web portal (website) <https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in> from 25/09/2026 Time 17:01 and shall be submitted online only. Amendment in tender, if any, will only be uploaded on the website and shall not be published in any newspaper.

NOTE: The interested tenderers for online submission of tender may contact CG e-Proc Helpdesk. Operated by **Mjunction Services Limited**, they may reach Helpdesk using 18004199140 (from 9 AM to 11 PM) (therein press 2 for CG e-Proc) or you can email them at Helpdesk_cgproc@cgssn.gov.in samvad 49178/3

Executive Engineer (Division-III)

**M.P. POWER GENERATING COMPANY LIMITED**
SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER (P&W), OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR (GEN.)
SANJAY GANDHI THERMAL POWER STATION, BIRSINGHPUR, DISTT.- UMARIA 484552 (M.P.)
E-mail : sepnw.sgtps@mppgcl.mp.gov.in, Fax No. : 07655-260226

No. 511-0100/SGTPS/P&W/E-NIT-26/2790 Birsinghpur, Date : 24.09.2026

E-TENDER INVITING NOTICE

M.P. POWER GENERATING CO. LTD. Invites Electronic tenders from manufacturer/reputed supplier/ contractor, for the supply/works of following items for SGTPS, MPPGCL Birsinghpur.

SL. No.	MPPGCL TENDER-ID	PARTICULARS	Estimate (In Rs.)	TENDER COST (In Rs.)	E.M.D. (In Rs.)	LAST DATE of closing of online submission	DUE DATE OF E-TENDER OPENING
01.	2026 MPPGC 520729_1	Bi-ennial work contract for operation and maintenance along with housekeeping of coal handling plant CHP-I (4X210 MW) & Wagon Tippler along with alternate coal path and CHP-II (1X500 MW) and manual unloading of coal from coal rake at old track hopper (OTH) & new track hopper (NTH) & at SGTPS, MPPGCL, Birsinghpur. (Contract Period : 2 Years)	89,01,28,000	5000/-	89,01,300/-	16.10.2026	22.10.2026

These tenders are being invited through e-tendering system/For viewing detailed E-NIT, downloading tender documents and participating in Electronic Tender, for any clarifications and/or due date extensions or corrigendum, please visit the website www.mptenders.gov.in regularly/Any clarifications and/or due date extensions or corrigendum shall be issued on the website www.mptenders.gov.in only/

// SAVE ELECTRICITY- SAVE POWER- SAVE MONEY //

M.P. Madhyam/128251/2026 SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER (P&W)

OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER PWD(R&B) DIVISION VIJAYPUR
ABBREVIATED NOTICE INVITING TENDER
e-NIT No. 56 of 2026-27 Dated 24-09-2026

For and on behalf of the Lieutenant Governor, Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir e-tenders are invited on percentage basis from approved and eligible Contractors registered with Union Territory of J&K, CPWD, Railways, MES and other State/Central Governments for each of the following works.

Sr. No	Name of Work	Estimated cost of Work (in Lacs)	Cost of Tender Doc. (in Rs.)	Earnest Money (In Rs.)	Time allowed for completion	Class of Contractor
1	Const. of Double Storey Examination Hall with 02 No. of ACR's at HS Mahal Shah.	150.00	3000	2% of Adv. Cost	12 Months (including all Rainy days)	"A"

Position of AAA :- Accorded
Position of T.S :- Sanctioned
Project Authority :- Under Capex Budget 2025-26 (UT Sector)

1	Date of Issue of Tender Notice	24-09-2026
2	Period of downloading of bidding documents	From 24-09-2026 to 07-10-2026
3	Date, Time and place of pre-bid meeting	25-09-2026 at 1300 Hrs in the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division Vijaypur
4	Bid submission Start Date	24-09-2026 at 1800 Hrs
5	Bid Submission End Date	07-10-2026 upto 1400
6	Date & time of opening of Technical Bids (Online)	07-10-2026 on or after 1600 Hrs in the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division Vijaypur
7	Date & time of opening of Financial Bids (Online)	To be notified after technical bid evaluation is completed

The tender is available at website <http://jktenders.gov.in> all other terms & conditions can be seen on the above website

No. PWD/V/4454-61
Dt. 24-09-2026
DIP No:DIP/J-11099/26

Sd/- Executive Engineer
PWD (R&B) Division,
Vijaypur

GOVERNMENT OF CHHATTISGARH, WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF ENGINEER
MAHANADI GODAWARI BASIN
RAIPUR (C.G.)

e-PROCUREMENT TENDER NOTICE
eProcurement Portal: <https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in>

(1st CALL)

System Tender No. : 199836/NIT No. : 09/SAC/2026-27, Rajnandgaon, Dated : 23.09.2026

Online Tenders are invited for the following works up to 14.10.2026 at 17.30 Hour

Name of work :- Renovation of head work & C.C Lining of Main Canal RD 0 M TO 4890 M with Construction of 05 nos. of VRB, 05 nos. of fall cum VRB & 20 nos. of outlet , Repair of Head Sluice , Waste weir and 01 No. of Aqueduct of Pinkapar Tank Scheme under Chhuriya Block of Rajnandgaon Distt.

Probable Amount of Contract :- **Rs. 268.57 Lakhs** (Excluding G.S.T.)

The details can be viewed and downloaded online directly from the Government of Chhattisgarh Integrated e-Procurement Portal (<https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in>) from **Date 30.09.2026, at 17.31 Hours.(IST)** onwards.

NOTE :- All eligible/intrested contractors/bidders are mandated to get enrolled on the Integrated e-procurement portal (<https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in>) and get approval on specific vendor class from PWD under Centralized Contractor/Supplier Registration in order to download the tender documents and participate in the subsequent bidding process.

Executive Engineer
Water Resources Division,
Rajnandgaon (C.G.)
For, Chief Engineer, Mahanadi Godawari Basin
Raipur (C.G.)

G 262703527/7

**ICICI Bank**

Branch Office: ICICI Bank Limited Plot No-23, Shal Tower, 3rd Floor, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi- 110005

The Authorised ICICI Bank Officer under the Securitisation, Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of the powers conferred under section 13(12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002, issued Demand Notices to the borrower(s) mentioned below, to repay the amount mentioned in the Notice within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said Notice.

Having failed to repay the amount, the Notice is issued to the borrower and the public in general that the undersigned has taken symbolic possession of the property described below, by exercising powers conferred on him/her under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said rules on the below-mentioned dates. The borrower in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with the property. Any dealings with the property will be subject to charges of ICICI Bank Limited.

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower(s)/ Loan Account Number	Description of Property/ Date of Symbolic Possession	Date of Demand Notice/ Amount in Demand Notice (Rs)	Name of Branch
1.	M/s. Star Surgical & Trading Company/ Anita Kapoor/ Rajan Kapoor/ Akshay Kapoor/ 113305001230	Address-1: Dda Built-up Shop Bearing No. 15 On Ground Floor, Area Measuring 19.31 Sq. Mtrs, Situated At Pocket-F, Commercial Shopping Center, Nand Nagri, Now Known As G.T.B Enclave, Delhi- 110093. Admeasuring An Area- 19.31 Sq. Mtrs Bounded By: North: Open South: Open East: Shop No. 16 West: Shop No. 14/ Date of Symbolic Possession September 22, 2026	May 26, 2026 Rs. 1,50,90,043.60/-	Delhi

The above-mentioned borrowers(s)/guarantors(s) is/are hereby issued a 30 day Notice to repay the amount, else the mortgaged properties will be sold after 30 days from the date of publishing this Notice, as per the provisions under Rules 8 and 9 of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002.

Date: September 26, 2026
Place: Delhi/Ncr

Sincerely Authorised Officer,
For ICICI Bank Ltd.

**ICICI Home Finance**

Corporate Office: ICICI Home Finance Company Limited, ICICI HFC Tower, Andheri - Kurla Road, Andheri (East), Mumbai - 400059, India
Branch Office: Plot no.19, Sector 12A, Opposite Bal Bharti School, Above ICICI Bank, Dwarka, New Delhi- 110075
[See proviso to rule 8(6)] Notice for sale of immovable assets

E-Auction Sale Notice for Sale of Immovable Assets under the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8 (6) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.

Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s) that the below described immovable property mortgaged/charged to the Secured Creditor, the Possession of which has been taken by the Authorized Officer of ICICI Home Finance Company Ltd., will be sold on "As is where is", "As is what is", and "Whatever there is", as per the brief particulars given hereunder;

Sr. No.	Name of Borrower(s)/ Co Borrowers/ Guarantors/ Legal Heirs. Loan Account No.	Details of the Secured asset(s) with known encumbrances, If any	Amount Outstanding	Reserve Price Earnest Money Deposit	Date and Time of Property Inspection	Date & Time of Auction	One Day Before Auction Date	SARFAESI Stage
(A)	(B)	(C)	(D)	(E)	(F)	(G)	(H)	(I)
1.	Suman Panika Borrower/ Ankit Dhaka (Co Borrower) Sunita Mann (Guarantors) Loan No. LHDWA00001593114	First Floor (RHS) Without Roof Rights, Freehold Property Bearing No. B-1, Ext. 41(A/-1, Ext. 41-A), Kharsa No. 13/5, Situated in The Revenue Estate Of Village Matiala Delhi, Colony Known As Block-B-1 Ext. Sewak Park, Uttam Nagar, Delhi-110059	Rs. 31,76,906/- September 22, 2026	Rs. 41,31,000/- Rs. 4,13,100/-	October 19, 2026 11:00 AM To 03:00 PM	October 28, 2026 02:00 PM To 03:00 PM	October 27, 2026 Before 05:00 PM	Symbolic Possession

The online auction will be conducted on website (URL Link- <https://BidDeal.in>) of our auction agency ValueTrust Capital Services Private Limited. The Mortgagees/ notice are given a last chance to pay the total dues with further interest till October 27, 2026 before 05:00 PM else these secured assets will be sold as per above schedule.

The Prospective Bidder(s) must submit the Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) RTGS/ Demand Draft (DD) (Refer Column E) at ICICI Home Finance Company Limited Branch Office Address mentioned on top of the article on or before October 27, 2026 before 04:00 PM. The Prospective Bidder(s) must also submit signed copy of Registration Form & Bid Terms and Conditions form at ICICI Home Finance Company Limited Branch Office Address mentioned on top of the article on or before October 27, 2026 before 05:00 PM. Earnest Money Deposit Demand Draft (DD) should be from a Nationalized/Scheduled Bank in favor of "ICICI Home Finance Company Ltd. - Auction" payable at the branch office address mentioned on top of the article.

For any further clarifications with regards to inspection, terms and conditions of the auction or submission of tenders, kindly contact ICICI Home Finance Company Limited on 9920807300.

The Authorized Officer reserves the right to reject any or all the bids without furnishing any further reasons. For detailed terms and conditions of the sale, please visit <https://www.icicifhc.com>.

Date: September 26, 2026
Place: Uttam Nagar

Authorized Officer, "ICICI Home Finance Company Limited",
CIN Number:- U65922MH1999PLC120106

GOVERNMENT OF JAMMU & KASHMIR
OFFICE OF THE MATERIALS MANAGEMENT OFFICER (Imports) SHER-I-KASHMIR INSTITUTE OF MEDICAL SCIENCES, SOURA-190011
Email: ammoimports@skims.ac.in, Fax: 0194-2403403
e-NIT No. SIMS-324-eNIT - 24 - (Imports) of 2026
DATED: 25/09/2026

Subject: -Abbreviated Notice inviting e-tenders for supply of various glass ware & plastic ware items at SKIMS, Soura, Srinagar on one year rate contract basis.

For and on behalf of Lt. Governor of Union Territory of Jammu & Kashmir, e-tender under two bid system are invited through Director Sher-i-Kashmir Institute of Medical Sciences from Original Manufacturers/ their authorized distributors/ dealers for supply of various Glass ware & Plastic ware items at SKIMS Soura, Srinagar on one year rate contract basis to be reckoned from the date of allotment of rate contract.

The detailed tender document is available on www.jktenders.gov.in in & on SKIMS website www.skims.ac.in & the NIT schedule is as following:

Last Date for submission of online bids	27/10/2026 upto 04:00 Pm
Opening of technical bids	05/11/2026
Last date for submission of original tender fee and EMD document	One day before opening of the technical bid.

Complete bidding process will be online on e-tender portal www.jktenders.gov.in & the tenders should be submitted strictly in accordance with the provisions of the detailed NIT.

No: SIMS-324-eNIT-24 -(Imports) of 2026 - 1760-67 Sd/-
Dated: 25/09/2026 Materials Management Officer
DIP No:DIPK-NB-1732/26 Imports, SKIMS



'I was just removed'

Actress Taapsee Pannu recalled the worst reason for being dropped from a film

Taapsee Pannu talked about some of the uncomfortable experiences she encountered in her acting career, from realising that she had been presented in a hypersexualised manner on screen to being removed from a film without being given a clear explanation. In a recent conversation with Nayanandee Rakshit, she shared how her lack of experience initially made her accept certain things as part of the job, only to understand their implications later. She also recalled being told that the hero's wife didn't want her in a film.

Taapsee spoke about being removed from a film after she had already committed to her dates. She said she was never given a concrete reason for the decision and was left wondering what had actually happened behind the scenes. "I have been told that I was replaced by the hero of the film. God knows the reason. I keep imagining the reasons. I can imagine the insecurity. I can imagine that he wanted someone else whom he was closer to. I can imagine various reasons, but I

wasn't given any solid reason. I was just told that he didn't want me in the film because I kept asking the reason for my removal."

This isn't the first time Taapsee has spoken about being dropped from a project. In a 2021 conversation with Siddharth Kannan, she recalled being finalised for a film before being removed and said she found out about the decision through the media.

"I was just removed. I got to know through the media. They called me, just to apologise, after I had spoken out. But still, they were hesitant to reveal the real reason behind the decision."

The episode appeared to relate to 'Pati Patni Aur Woh', which eventually starred Kartik Aaryan, Bhumi Pednekar and Ananya Panday. At the time, Taapsee had publicly questioned the way she was removed from the project, while the producers said she had been among several actresses considered for the role and that they had not made a commitment to her.

Taapsee also shared one of the reasons she was given for being replaced in another film. AGENCIES

THIS ISN'T THE FIRST TIME SHE HAS SPOKEN ABOUT BEING DROPPED FROM A PROJECT

LOVE & WAR

Alia unveils her first look poster



Bhatt shared the poster on her 'Instagram' handle on Friday

Alia Bhatt shared her first look poster from Sanjay Leela Bhansali's directorial 'Love & War'.

The poster featured the actress resembling a cabaret dancer as she wore a red sequined top and slit skirt with a feathery head accessory.

Bhatt shared the poster on her 'Instagram' handle on Friday, a day after the makers released the first look poster of her husband and actor Ranbir Kapoor from the film.

"Reunited. Sanjay Leela Bhansali's 'Love & War'. January 21, 2027. See you at the movies," she wrote in the caption.

The film reunites Bhatt and Kapoor with the filmmaker. Bhatt was the protagonist of Bhansali's last

big-screen outing, 'Gangubai Kathiawadi' in 2022. Kapoor made his acting debut with Bhansali's 'Saawariya', which didn't perform at the box office. 'Love & War', which is set to release on January 27, 2027, also features Vicky Kaushal. It is Kaushal and Bhansali's first film. The film is produced by Bhansali under his banner 'Bhansali Productions'.

PTI

'KALKI 2898 AD' SEQUEL

'It is going to be bigger in scale & emotions'

Winning two National Film Awards for 'Kalki 2898 AD' seems like a pat on the back for years of hard work, said director Nag Ashwin, promising the second part of the movie, starring Prabhas, will be bigger and better.

Produced by 'Vyjayanthi Movies', 'Kalki 2898 AD' was praised for blending sci-fi with Indian mythology when it was released in June 2024. The film recently won National Awards for 'Best Popular Film Providing Wholesome Entertainment' and 'Best Special Effects' at a ceremony in Kevadia, Gujarat.

"It's very special as it's the National Award. It somehow feels like a pat on the back for all the years of hard work that we put in. Especially the production design," the actor-director told PTI in an interview.

Ashwin said an 'insane amount' of work went into building the world of 'Kalki 2898 AD' and now, he is



FOR FILMMAKER NAG ASHWIN, WINNING TWO NATIONAL FILM AWARDS FOR THE FILM SEEMS LIKE A PAT ON THE BACK FOR YEARS OF HARD WORK

busy developing the sequel. "It's a lot of the same world, characters and finishing the same story. But it's also the heart of the story now and how it all comes together. So, it's definitely going to be bigger in scale and emotions," he said.

The original film, set in a dystopian future in the year 2898 AD in the city of Kashi, follows a group on a mission to protect lab subject SUM-80's unborn child, believed to be Kalki, the final incarnation of Vishnu. Written and directed by Ashwin, the film featured an ensemble cast including Amitabh Bachchan, Kamal Haasan, Prab-

has, Deepika Padukone, Shobana and Disha Patani. Padukone is no longer a part of the sequel after the makers announced last year that they had decided to part ways.

Ashwin is happy that mythology is emerging as a favourite genre in cinema. "In the past two years, we have seen not just established filmmakers, but even young filmmakers explore this genre more and more. I think even producers have begun to trust stories from this genre. It's going to be an exciting next few years," he added.

Ashwin also praised Prabhas, his lead star in 'Kalki 2898 AD'. PTI

ANEES BAZMEE, SANJAY MISHRA & OTHERS REMEMBER MUSHTAQ KHAN

Celebrities including Anees Bazmee, Sanjay Mishra, Rajpal Yadav, Sunny Deol and others remembered 'remarkable artist' Mushtaq Khan.

Khan, who has been in projects such as 'Welcome', 'Gadar' and 'Hum Hai Rahi Pyaar Ke', was admitted to Nanavati Hospital in suburban Mumbai. He died after a battle with cancer on Thursday at the age of 75.

Filmmaker Bazmee, who worked with the actor in 'Welcome', shared a post on his 'Instagram' handle and said he is shocked by the news about Khan's passing. "Shocked and speechless by the passing of Mushtaq Bhai (my balu). A truly remarkable artist and a beautiful soul," he wrote.

Yadav wrote a note and shared a picture of the late actor as he recalled meeting him earlier in



the day. "This afternoon, I went to meet Mushtaq Bhai, talked to him; he saw me, shook my hand

KHAN DIED AFTER A BATTLE WITH CANCER AT THE AGE OF 75

and listened to all our conversations and reacted to them," he said.

"Can't believe the person I met two hours ago, the person I shook hands with, is no longer among us. We are all bowing down to the decision of the Almighty. Mushtaq Bhai was, is and will always be a popular person and actor and will remain so. I offer you a heartfelt tribute with a heavy heart," he added.

Deol shared a picture of the late actor and remembered Khan as 'a nice human and fine actor'. "Sad to hear about Mush-

taq Khan. My condolences to his family," he wrote.

Mishra posted a picture alongside the actor on his story as he remembered him. "Mushtaq bhai, we always learned a lot by holding your finger. And today Mohsin's father left us. Let's meet in that world. Wherever you are, stay calm and happy," he wrote.

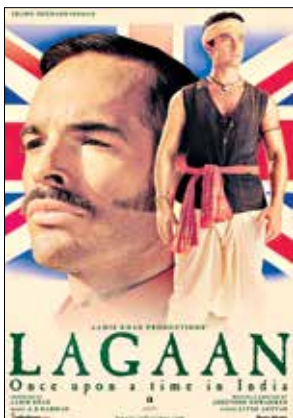
The news of Khan's death was confirmed by his son Mohsin.

In a career of over five decades, Khan acted in over 500 movies and garnered wide popularity through his supporting roles. Some of his films include 'Aashiqui', 'Saathi', 'Sadak', 'Junoon', 'Gunaah', 'Sir', 'Dil Hai Ki Manta Nahin', 'Gadar', 'Welcome', 'Gadar 2' and others.

Khan's funeral was held yesterday. He is survived by his wife, son and daughter. PTI

Aamir Khan to receive Screen Icon Award

He will be honoured at the Singapore International Film Festival



Superstar Aamir Khan is set to receive the Screen Icon Award at the 37th Singapore International Film Festival (SGIFF), where he will also attend a special 25th-anniversary screening of his Oscar-nominated film 'Lagaan: Once Upon a Time in India'.

The actor-filmmaker will attend the screening of the 2001 period sports drama alongside its director Ashutosh Gowariker. He will also be among the speakers at the festival's 'In Conversation With' series, reported 'Variety'.

Set in 1893, when India was ruled by the British, 'Lagaan' follows the residents of a small village who, crushed under oppressive taxes imposed by a ruthless British officer, stake their fate on an unlikely game of cricket to escape the burden.

The SGIFF, which will be held from October 21 to November 1, will feature

appearances by several prominent Asian filmmakers and actors, including Japanese filmmaker Hirokazu Kore-eda and Hong Kong actor Anthony Wong.

The festival will open with South Korean political thriller "The Assassin(s)", starring Yoo Hae-jin, Park Hae-il and Lee Min-ho. Director Hur Jin-ho and cast members Shim Eun-kyung and Park Sung-hoon will attend the opening.

Kore-eda, known for films including 'Nobody Knows', 'Like Father, Like Son', 'Monster' and Palme d'Or winner 'Shoplifters', will receive the festival's Cinema Honorary Award for his contribution to Asian cinema. His latest film, 'Look Back', will have its Southeast Asian premiere at SGIFF. PTI



HE WILL ALSO ATTEND A SPECIAL 25TH-ANNIVERSARY SCREENING OF 'LAGAAN'